

LUKE 444

Written by

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"Congestive Heart Failure" Joke by

Matt Colbo

PART 1:

CLOWN INFESTED AREAS

FADE IN:

INT. CALEB'S KITCHEN - DAY

A label marked "BILLS" sticks above a weaved-basket filled with mail.

MATT COLLINS (25) perches on a sofa with his dress shirt buttoned all the way up, but not tucked in, his long hair sticking all over the place, and dark circles under his eyes.

He cradles a beer with both hands.

MATT

Assuming you are healthy, your heart when working normally, acts, sort of like a pump, or rather, two pumps.

He shares a comforter with CALEB COLLINS (22), who looks equally haggard, but is more clean shaven.

MATT (CONT'D)

You see your right heart expands to draw deoxygenated blood in from the body and contracts to pump it out to the lungs to become oxygenated. And at the same time, your left heart draws in oxygenated blood from the lungs and then pumps it out to the rest of your stupid, misshapen body.

Caleb closes his eyes forcefully, as if trying to shut his brother out of his life.

MATT (CONT'D)

Now sometimes, irregularities can occur that prevent your heart from pumping properly. "Congestive Heart Failure" is an interesting one. Say your heart loses some of its contractile force due to high blood pressure, for example.

JUSTIN JONES (33) looms over a large map of the district, spectacles showing his age, cup of coffee in hand, blueprints pushed off to the side.

MATT (O.S.) (CONT'D)

This will result in the pooling of blood in your left heart, or left ventricle chamber, and in response to this, the cells in your left ventricle will enlarge to push against the higher circulatory resistance caused by the increase in blood pressure, which is a great solution, but only in the short term.

SAMMY SMITH (29) in hoodie and sweats receives a text and shows it to Justin.

ON PHONE

"80 6 if shtf"

MATT (O.S.) (CONT'D)

Much like your parents' decision to try to save their marriage by having, well, you.

JUSTIN

(quietly)

What is shtf?

MATT (O.S.)

But because of these enlarged cells, the left ventricle chamber then becomes much smaller.

SAMMY

(mouthing)

Shit hits fan.

Justin looks at it, looks to the Caleb and Matt, and nods to Sammy.

MATT (O.S.)

Resulting in less blood being able to fill into it.

Sammy deletes it off his phone.

MATT (O.S.) (CONT'D)

And because the blood coming into the left ventricle has nowhere to go, it begins to back up into the lungs and from there, because it's all a cycle, it'll back up into the right heart and then you've got congestive heart failure on your hands.

Justin places a red thimble on the map and lowers his head to level of the table before him.

JUSTIN

Itinerary one more time?

MATT (O.S.)

Not unlike, how the incessant, heated disagreements between your timeworn mother and father is also, on your hands. The name "Congestive Heart Failure" though is apt because fluid then leaks into your alveolar air spaces making it difficult to breathe, and with all this, blood pressure increases, yet again.

SAMMY

Yezzir. Costumes 2015. En route to garage by 2030.

MATT (V.O.)

And the original hypertrophy of muscle cells in your left ventricle is no longer a help, and since the contractile force of your heart has decreased...

Justin moves a red thimble on the map from one location to the next.

SAMMY

Makeup from 2100 to 2130.

MATT (V.O.)

It certainly can't pump against the new, much higher resistance and because of that...

SAMMY

Alleyway on Brooklyn Ave by 2200.
En route to 15th Ave by 2215 by I-5.
Estimated time of arrival 2230.

Justin slowly moves the red thimble from the alleyway behind garage through traffic to 15th Ave.

MATT

Your body in response to the heart not pumping sufficient blood, thinks "well gee golly, ha, I mustn't have enough fluid!" So it tells your kidneys then to return any liquid you take in, meaning you'll retain a lot more water.

SAMMY

Out of the house by 2300. En route by foot to A Lot Like Bar with an ETA of 2315.

Justin moves the red thimble to the bar down the street.

Sammy tries to block out Matt, who just seems to be getting louder and louder.

MATT (O.S.)

Which has to go somewhere, so it leaks into your legs, abdomen, and all over the body, and can result in the gaining of 2 to 3 pounds per day.

SAMMY

Out of bar by 2330. En route to Kappa Sigma Fraternity by foot with an ETA of 2345.

Justin moves the thimble from the bar to the frat house.

MATT (O.S.)

Which as you can imagine, will cause rapid accumulation of total body weight.

SAMMY

From there, we have an exit time of 0100, en route to 21st Street house party by 0130.

Justin moves the thimble to 21st.

MATT

And after just one month, someone afflicted by this disease could amass up to 100 extra pounds!

Sammy looks over at Matt, distracted. Justin looks too.

SAMMY

Out of 21st by 0145, with an ETA to garage by 0300.

Justin moves the thimble back to the garage.

MATT (O.S.)

There is effectively no way that a human being could gain weight at this rate, by any other mechanism.

SAMMY

Pre-trip okay?

JUSTIN

Pre-trip okay.

The two look over at the brothers on the couch. Caleb finally sits up and rubs the sleep from his eyes.

MATT

And that is why, it seems as though it is the only rational explanation as to what must be happening to your mom.

Caleb laughs his contagious, smoker laugh.

CALEB

We have the same mom, dick.

MATT

It's a good joke though, no?

Justin walks over to the CALENDAR next to the basket of bills.

He grabs the magnetic marker on top and circles the 31st day of October.

JUSTIN

Happy Halloween.

SAMMY

Happy Halloween.

MATT

Happy hallo fucking ween.

Matt tosses a beer over to his brother.

CALEB

I'm thirsty.

Caleb pops open the beer. He slurps it down to keep it from fizzing out.

EXT. JUSTIN'S APARTMENT - DAY

The four friends -- dressed in clown outfits, but with no make-up on -- stand on the second level of the apartment building.

Justin locks up the apartment with a big black duffle bag slung across his shoulders.

Sammy smokes a pink e-cig, while looking at his phone.

Matt stands with his hands in his pocket, blank staring out over the railing.

Caleb smokes a cig, with sunglasses on his face and a flask in his hand.

MARY (60s), Justin's neighbor, places her hand to her chest as she tries to walk by the clowns.

CALEB

Hi, how are ya?

Caleb gives her a friendly nod and smile, SMOKE EXHALING out of his nostrils.

EXT. STREET - DAY

A toddler plays in the grass. He points to the four friends walking down the middle of the isolated street.

The boy's mother throws them a death glare and picks up her son.

In the direction the friends are going, traffic looks hectic.

Charlie looks to the opposite side of the street of the mother and sees a waitress tending tables at an outside restaurant.

Her and the customers give them no heed, as if every day normal life.

Coming up to the intersection, a college-aged person dressed up as a cow and another dressed up as a cowboy carry a shit ton of beer.

COW

Hey, hey, hey! Clowns! Whoo.

The cow tosses Matt a beer.

MATT

Ya boy.

Justin gently pushes Matt in the shoulder toward the correct destination.

The four friends walk up a driveway to a detached, rundown garage.

INT. COLLINS GARAGE - DAY

A large, dirty mirror sits in the middle of the garage, with boxes stacked high around it.

Caleb sits in an old-school barber chair. Justin slowly applies clown make-up onto his face, while he smokes a cig like a crack addict.

Matt, already with make-up on, looks incredibly focused lying on a couch playing with a Rubik's cube.

He glances at the movie HIGH NOTE playing on the tiny TV plugged into a generator.

Sammy sits diligently at Matt's feet sipping a beer from a cozy.

He takes a drag from his e-cig and blows out smoke.

SAMMY

You know that your sense of hearing
is the last sense to go after you
die.

Matt works on his Rubik's cube, Justin applies make-up, and Caleb sits pleasantly as the makeup is applied to him.

SAMMY (CONT'D)

So when a person dies, he or she
will hear what you say to them
(looks over at Matt)
right before they pass over.

CALEB

A little morbid.

JUSTIN

Don't move.

Matt sits up slightly, no longer focused on his cube.

MATT

What the shit. Is that true? Do you think that's why people always have some sort of catch phrase after they kill someone in the movies?

Matt excitedly sits up higher.

MATT (CONT'D)

Hasta la vista, baby. Do I feel lucky? Well, do ya punk. Famous last words heard by the punks getting their good in.

Matt sits flabbergasted as to why the others aren't as excited as he is.

SAMMY

Harry doesn't kill him in that movie though.

MATT

Yes, he does.

SAMMY

Have you ever even seen Dirty Harry?

MATT

Regardless, I think it's blasphemous that movies haven't even acknowledged this fact.

CALEB

I'm pretty sure Arnold says that line and then blows the T1000 away, too.

Matt looks at each of his friends. All three go about their business as usual.

MATT

I guess it's just me that thought that was an interesting fact, Sammy.

SAMMY

It's okay.

Matt lies back down on the sofa.

CALEB

Why you so serious?

JUSTIN

A manner in which a person does a
thing is a manner in which said
person will do most things.

Justin takes a drag as he does the finishing touches. Caleb
contemplates what Justin just said.

JUSTIN (CONT'D)

What do you think?

Caleb and Justin nod their heads together in approval looking
at themselves in the mirror.

INT. COLLINS GARAGE - DAY

Time lapse of the four friends doing various activities to
stay busy.

EXT. ALLEYWAY - JUSTIN'S CAR - SUNSET

Garbage litters the alleyway.

The four friends stand next to each other in front of a piece
of shit Toyota Corolla.

Justin watches the map and blueprints from before catch on
fire. He then uses the FLAMES to light a cigarette.

MATT

Goin' to a Chapel and we're...

Matt comes in and lights his own.

MATT (CONT'D)

Goin' to get married...

Matt shakes Caleb excitedly.

INT. JUSTIN'S CAR - SUNSET

The four friends drive through heavy traffic to their first
party. Caleb and Matt drink beers, while Justin smokes a
cigarette. Sammy sits neatly in the passenger seat with good
posture.

The Toyota crawls to a stop at a traffic light.

A police car barely makes the light going the other direction
and pulls up alongside them.

Two cops look right at the friends.

Justin blows out his drag and gives the cops a little wave and a smile that says, "Hi, how's it going?"

Matt rolls down his window, chewing gum and wearing aviators.

He stares down the cops with a smile. The cops stare back. Cops drive off.

MATT

Cot Dayum, fuckin' pigs.

CALEB

God damn, fuckin' pigs.

SAMMY

God damn, fuckin' pigs.

JUSTIN

God damn, fuckin' pigs.

Daniel turns on a SONG from his iPhone. The blown out speaker in the back does its best to handle the bass.

Justin drives off across the city and into the sunset.

INT. FIRST HALLOWEEN PARTY - NIGHT

The four friends walk into the packed house filled with many different costumed people.

Beautiful, scantily-dressed women dance with each other.

Scooby Doo and Shaggy play beer pong.

A fucked-up Randy Johnson smokes a blunt.

The three friends mix into the various social groups.

Justin greets one of his friends quickly and heads toward the back room. He beckons for the others to follow.

All four enter the back room.

INT. FIRST HALLOWEEN PARTY - HALLWAY - NIGHT

The friends exit the back room looking slightly more fucked up and head outside on their way to another party.

EXT. MARS BAR - NIGHT

Justin, Matt, Caleb, and Sammy receive the help of a bouncer, dressed normally, but with cat whiskers drawn on his face, to skip the long line of costumed people.

The bouncer and Sammy catch up as the Justin, Matt, and Caleb head inside.

Justin flicks out his cigarette and throws it away before he enters, his face serious as he makes eye contact with a group of females still waiting in line.

INT. MARS BAR - SAME TIME

The friends enter into a overflowing, costumed bar.

Three ghosts sing CONSTANT SORROW on stage.

They see their friend ANDREW (late 20s) bartending who offers them free shots. They each take them quickly and mingle through the crowd.

They make their way up to the

SECOND FLOOR

and pass another bouncer with whiskers into a more secluded room. A few men dressed in suits sit along a brown, leather sofa.

The men greet Sammy cheerfully, then shake hands with the three other clown friends.

The door closes.

EXT. KAPPA SIGMA FRATERNITY - NIGHT

Besides the spatter of beer cans, the house looks richly decorated, with the lawn neatly trimmed.

Fraternity brothers dressed as members from TOY STORY do a two-story beer bong.

Justin, Matt, and Sammy walk up to the front door. Caleb greets a few members before catching up with the others.

INT. ALPHA OMEGA FRATERNITY - SAME TIME

Justin, Matt, Caleb, and Sammy enter the three story frat house and witness a boatload of fraternity brothers and sorority sisters dressed in costumes.

They bump and grind together, as if it went out of style ten years ago.

Three bros walk up to the clowns aggressively. Caleb comes from behind to greet them by jumping into one of their arms.

The bros see that it's Caleb and greet him with enthusiasm.

They then shower the rest of the clown friends with enthusiasm. One bro takes them into an elegant dining room filled with other frat brothers doing lines of cocaine off of a large, glass dining room table.

The door closes.

EXT. LAST HALLOWEEN PARTY - NIGHT

Justin, Caleb, Matt, and Sammy walk up the concrete steps to a house that would look nice if college kids weren't living in it.

The shrubs are overgrown, trash is thrown across the grass, and one of the windows in the front is completely missing.

Girls use a slip n' slide in their skimpy outfits.

The outside has a large amount of students going crazy -- far more than the other parties.

INT. LAST HALLOWEEN PARTY - NIGHT

Foam escapes the adjacent foam-filled living room.

Two guys looking like JOHN TRAVOLTA and SAMUEL L. JACKSON from PULP FICTION dispense ecstasy pills from their silver guns into the mouths of random people.

Matt quickly makes out with a random chick and becomes the life of the party.

INT. LAST HALLOWEEN PARTY - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Justin, out in front, turns a corner -- his expression turns from smiling drunk to serious. A STROBE LIGHT SHINES across his serious, clown face.

The three others right behind him. They also turn serious.

The friends run into a huge guy named BIG D (24) guarding a door to one of the back rooms.

Matt greets him enthusiastically.

MATT

Big D, hows the big dick treating
ya?

Big D gives Matty a smile.

BIG D

Matty, always commenting on my big
dick.

He greets Matt back and lets Matt, Sammy, and Caleb into the back room.

Justin stays outside with the big guy.

BIG D (CONT'D)

You're not coming in?

JUSTIN

Nope.

John Travolta and Samuel L. Jackson walk by and greet Big D, and then make their way in.

BIG D

You sure?

JUSTIN

Yep.

Justin and Big D stare at each other.

INT. LAST HALLOWEEN PARTY DRUG ROOM - NIGHT

The Head Honcho (24), his Colleague (23), two college-aged female students, plus the three clowns sit openly in the room filled with couches and glass mirrors.

Lines of cocaine spread across each and every one of the mirrors.

The Colleague hands a mirror to Matt.

John Travolta and Samuel L. Jackson walk in and pat Matt on the back.

MATT

So, three guys were talking one morning about how drunk they were--

JOHN TRAVOLTA

That's what I like to see, Matty.

SAMUEL L. JACKSON

Matty Ice, back in his natural habitat.

MATT

Hey what's up, guys. About how drunk they were the night before.

Matt holds everyone's attention to focus on him as he snorts a fat line of coke.

MATT (CONT'D)

First guy. Man, I was so drunk last night I got home and blew chunks.

Sammy greets The Head Hauncho, who looks like your everyday college student that excels in chemistry, and hands him an envelope filled with cash.

MATT (CONT'D)

Second guy. Oh, yeah? Well, I was so drunk that on the way home I was pulled over and given a DUI!

John Travolta dispenses a pill out of his gun into the mouth of one of the girls.

MATT (CONT'D)

Third guy. That's nothing. I was so drunk that on the way home, I picked up a prostitute and my wife caught us in bed!

Sammy follows The Head Hauncho goes back to a closet.

MATT (CONT'D)

First guy. No, no... You guys don't understand. Chunks is my dog.

While everyone laughs at Matt, Sammy pulls out a huge fucking Colt .45 and hits The Head Hauncho in the back of the head.

Caleb slowly pulls out a SAWED-OFF SHOTGUN and BLASTS a lamp to smithereens when Colleague attempts to go for a gun.

The room quickly goes still.

Matt pulls two 9mm pistols and aims it at John Travolta and Samuel L. Jackson.

INT. LAST HALLOWEEN PARTY HALLWAY - SAME TIME

Justin stands outside intently watching Big D.

The SOUND of Caleb's shotgun blast barely penetrates the loud EDM MUSIC PLAYING in the house.

Justin slowly pulls out his pistol as Big D turns to put his ear to the door.

Justin grabs him and pushes him through it.

INT. LAST HALLOWEEN PARTY DRUG ROOM - SAME TIME

Justin hits Big D over and over again until the big man stops moving on the ground.

Justin, Matt, and Caleb forcefully shoves everyone onto the ground.

JUSTIN
Time, Sammy?

Sammy checks his watch.

SAMMY
Four minutes sixteen.

Justin tosses Matt a bag of zip ties.

JUSTIN
Matty.

Matt and Caleb begin tying up the drug dealers.

Justin searches the closet. Sammy pushes The Head Hauncho over to Matty and Caleb.

Justin pulls out a shoebox full of cash and another one filled with pills. Sammy comes over and helps search.

Matt pulls out ball gags and starts putting them in each of the dealers' mouths.

Caleb ties up The Head Hauncho.

Justin dumps both boxes into Sammy's tiny clown back pack. He grabs the main dealer's face menacingly.

JUSTIN (CONT'D)
Where's the blow?

He shoves his face away.

JUSTIN (CONT'D)
Sammy, look under the bed. Caleb
check the cushions.

Justin throws him a long knife.

JUSTIN (CONT'D)
Time?

SAMMY
One Minute ten.

Matt puts the ball gag into The Head Hauncho's mouth.

BANGING comes from the door.

The friends freeze.

Matt high-tails it to the door.

Matt, Justin, and Sammy look at each other. Caleb finds the kilos of blow and excitedly non-screams in delight.

Justin puts up his finger to shush him.

JUSTIN
(quietly)
To Sammy.

Justin stands next to Matt. Caleb puts the blow into Sammy's bag.

Matt cracks open the door.

Justin, Sammy, and Caleb hold guns to the dealers' heads as they try calling out for help.

The girl Matt was kissing earlier peeks at Matt through the cracked-open door.

MATT
Five minutes, baby girl.

RANDOM GIRL
Hurry up, Matty.

MATT
Promise. Five minutes.

The girl walks away. Matt shuts the door.

Caleb, Justin, and Sammy start grabbing their belongings and tidying up their costumes.

Matt pulls his gun on the closest dealer to him, who is still trying to make as much noise as possible.

MATT (CONT'D)

You ready for my catch phrase?

Matt cocks his pistol. Justin grabs his arms and pushes the pistol away.

JUSTIN

What the fuck are you doing?

MATT

What? I'm just messing around.

He pushes Matt towards the door.

Justin lets Caleb and Sammy exit the now calm back room first. He pushes Matt to follow him.

JUSTIN

Go.

Justin looks back at all of the tied up, struggling college drug dealers.

He gives them a little salute and exits.

EXT. LAST HALLOWEEN PARTY - NIGHT

The friends exit the party. The partygoers unaware of what had just occurred.

They walk towards the back of the house into the

ALLEYWAY

They get into the Toyota Corolla.

Justin takes off his wig, as Sammy begins changing out of his outfit.

Matt, still in costume, jumps around in the back excitedly.

MATT

Oh, man. You should have seen their faces. So good.

CALEB
(mockingly)
You ready for my catchphrase.

Matt and Caleb burst out laughing.

The two friends in the front aren't as enthused, but Justin manages a smile.

The friends drive away.

FADE TO BLACK:

EXT. UNIVERSITY WAY - NIGHT

A slight snow gently comes down onto the usually busy street and begins covering all of the cars that are parked along the side.

I'M DREAMING OF A WHITE CHRISTMAS PLAYS in the background.

Justin stands next to his car dressed in a Santa outfit. He smokes a cigarette with his fake beard pulled down.

He goes to the trunk. As he opens it, he slips on the snow and hits his shin.

JUSTIN
Mother fucker.

Clearly frustrated, he puts his head onto the license plate.

He grabs two handguns and checks them, and places them on his bulletproof vest.

He buttons his Santa coat up.

Justin grabs a long knife and puts it on his boot and walks back to the front to finish his cigarette.

Matt -- dressed in an elf outfit -- and Caleb -- dressed in a Frosty the Snowman outfit -- walk up to Justin.

MATT
Hi, Santa.

CALEB
Hey, Santa. Good morning.

JUSTIN
Ol' Saint Nick to you.

Justin puts his beard on. He leans down and pokes his head next to the car window.

Sammy sits in the passenger seat in a reindeer outfit.

JUSTIN (CONT'D)
You coming, Sammy?

Sammy stares at his friend. He reluctantly gets out.

The four friends head to a house that looks to be having a Christmas party.

Matt gets really excited and keeps jumping on the other friends.

Justin keeps shrugging him off. He flicks his cigarette out with his fingers and tosses it.

FADE OUT.

PART 2:

A ROGUE BEAVER

FADE IN:

INT. JENKINS' BEDROOM - NIGHT

A cell phone vibrates on a dresser next to a man and woman in bed.

JIM JENKINS (50s), bald on top and wearing silk pajamas, reaches over and grabs it.

He looks at the number and sits up.

Jim sighs, rubs his face, and answers.

JIM
This better be fuckin' important,
Nervon.

The man on the other end, Nervon, stammers.

NERVON (V.O.)
Um, sir. We have a beaver.

Jim closes his eyes.

Long sigh.

JIM
I'll be there within the hour.

NERVON (V.O.)
Okay, bu--

Jim hangs up.

Jim's wife, NANCY (50s), peeks out from behind her sleep mask.

NANCY
Who was that, honey?

JIM
Nervous Nervon. I gotta go in
early. Could be a long day. Go back
to sleep.

Jim kisses his wife and heads toward the bathroom.

INT. UNDISCLOSED LOCATION - HALLWAY - EARLY MORNING

A shackled prisoner dressed in white walks backwards.

Two armed guards, one in front and one behind him, accompany the young man.

NICK FRAZEE (20s) shows a face of annoyance as he gets stopped and started without warning from the two guards.

The group walks through two security doors into what appears to be an entryway into an office lunchroom.

A glass wall with glass doors divide the entryway from the lunchroom.

The group crosses the entryway and stops at yet another security door.

GUARD

Frazee, Nickolas to interrogation.

DISPATCH (V.O.)

Hold for buzz.

Nick peers into the lunchroom and sees a lone man in a bland suit near one of the coffee machines.

He also notices four large flat screens playing a mixture of CNN and Fox News.

The security door BUZZES and then opens.

Nick and the lone lunchroom man catch each other's eyes before the guards push him through the door.

INT. UNDISCLOSED LOCATION - LUNCHROOM - EARLY MORNING

Jim, in a bland suit and sweater vest, pours a cup of coffee. His briefcase lies on the counter next to the coffee maker.

NERVON BELASTIGEN (20s), tall and skinny, in a white shirt and tie, fingers his glasses back onto his face as he walks toward Jim.

Jim, mixing in his cream and sugar, notices Nervon.

JIM

Oh, no you don't. Not until I've had my coffee.

NERVON

Sir, we may--

JIM
God fuckin' dammit, Nervon. Not
until I've had my goddamn cup of
coffee.

Jim walks briskly past Nervon, spilling slightly.

He flicks the coffee off of his thumb and mutters under his
breath.

INT. UNDISCLOSED LOCATION - INTERROGATION ROOM - EARLY
MORNING

Jim stands behind the one-way mirror, drinking his cup of
coffee, and stares at a report in his hand

Nick sits on the other side of the mirror in handcuffs.

Nervon walks in.

NERVON
Sir, as I was saying--

Jim holds up the report.

JIM
Too late, Nervon. Got the report
right here.

NERVON
But, sir--

JIM
Nervon, what's this in my hand?

NERVON
A cup of coffee, sir.

JIM
That's right. And is it finished?

NERVON
Nn- no, sir.

JIM
That's right.

Jim goes back to reading the report.

A long beat, with Nick in the background.

JIM (CONT'D)
Hm.

Jim finishes his coffee with a big gulp.

JIM (CONT'D)
It doesn't say who he's affiliated
with.

NERVON
As I was saying--

JIM
Get the big three on the line.
Doubt it's from Bewkes or Murdoch.

Jim hands the report over to Nervon and grabs his briefcase.

JIM (CONT'D)
My money is on Immelt. The leaky
sons of bitches. God, you can lead
a horse to water...

NERVON
Sir, I just talked with them.

Beat.

JIM
And? Jesus, Nervon, here's the
perfect time for the fuckin'
punchline.

NERVON
They have no idea who he is.

Jim sticks his tongue between his upper lip and gums.

He smacks his lips.

JIM
A rogue fuckin' beaver. Jeez, this
day just keeps getting better and
better.

Jim straightens his tie and heads toward the door that leads
to Nick.

JIM (CONT'D)
Bring me more coffee when you come
in.

Jim enters the interrogation room that is holding Nick.

INT. UNDISCLOSED LOCATION - INTERROGATION ROOM - EARLY MORNING

Nick watches the lone lunchroom man in a bland suit place his briefcase on top of the table.

He gives Nick a quick smile.

JIM
Good morning.

Jim notices the guard standing in the corner and laughs.

JIM (CONT'D)
Stevenson! How the hell are you? I didn't know they put you on this detail.

STEVENSON
I'm good, sir.

JIM
Your wife get those cookies?

STEVENSON
Yes, sir.

JIM
Verdict?

STEVENSON
Scrumptious, sir.

JIM
That's what I like to hear. I'll inform the missus.

Jim meticulously takes out a folder, two pens, a notepad, and a pencil and he places them neatly in front of him.

He slides a pack of smokes and lighter to the middle of the desk without looking up from his report.

JIM (CONT'D)
(to Nick)
Is there anything I can get you before we start?

Nick doesn't respond. He stares at the pack of cigarettes before him.

JIM (CONT'D)
Wonderful.

Jim pulls out one of his pens and puts on his bifocals.

JIM (CONT'D)
I'm Jim Jenkins, Chief
Interrogation Officer with an
undisclosed intelligence agency
somewhat affiliated with The United
States. And you are a Mr. Nickolas
Frazee. There will be four--

NICK
I'm sorry. Undisclosed intelligence
agency somewhat affiliated with th--

Jim looks up from his report.

JIM
United States. Yes.

NICK
I-- I don't understand.

JIM
Which part?

NICK
All of it, I guess.

Jim places his pen down.

JIM
Can you be a little more specific?

NICK
The undisclosed intelligence agency
somewhat affiliated with The United
States part, I guess.

JIM
We are somewhat affiliated with the
United States because we are not
officially recognized by The United
States, or her allies for that
matter. But make no mistake,
everything that you see presently
within your current reality is, in
fact, the property of the United
States. Including myself. And
Officer Stevenson.

Nick contemplates what he just said.

NICK

I'm still not sure what you are saying.

Jim sets his pen down.

JIM

I am saying that The United States owns and operates everything that you see before you unofficially. Officially, everything you see before you is considered "off the books". We are like that side income that people never disclose on their taxes. Sometimes used for the good of the world, but most often used for nefarious purposes. We are the gray area. The break between people and government. We are-- What's that word you used, Stevenson?

STEVENSON

Caesura, sir.

JIM

Caesura, yes. We are the metrical pause where one phase, the United States, ends and another, the people, begins. We are the break between the two.

Jim chuckles to himself after that last statement.

NICK

So, who do you report to?

JIM

We report to no one, and we report to everyone.

NICK

That doesn't make any sense either.

Jim picks up his pen and starts writing.

JIM

Well, life rarely makes sense.

NICK

I see.

A long beat, as Jim scribbles down notes.

NICK (CONT'D)
Do you mind if I ask you a question
that's been buggin' me?

Jim puts down his pen one more time.

He gestures for Nick to ask away.

NICK (CONT'D)
Why do you guys watch both CNN and
Fox? I mean, I realize that they
are both part of the "controlled
opposition", but what is it? Is it
to keep tabs on the reporters or
something? Make sure they follow
the narrative?

Jim picks up the pencil this time and writes in his notepad.

JIM
We do not need to keep tabs on our
reporters because our reporters
never-- never-- deviate from the
narrative that we prescribe them.
Standard protocol is to switch it
to CNN and Fox News when there's a
civilian or citizen in the
building. Usually, the televisions
are filled with whatever case is of
importance.

He looks up at Nick's confused look.

JIM (CONT'D)
You are the civilian.

NICK
Where do you usually get your news?

JIM
We don't usually get our news.

NICK
What does that mean?

JIM
It means you, curious sir, are in
way over your head.

NICK
Is that what these handcuffs are
for?

Nick lifts his handcuffed hands up in the air.

NICK (CONT'D)
That guy also said I wasn't allowed
a lawyer.

Jim doesn't look up and continues to write in the notepad.

JIM
That guy is right.

NICK
No lawyer, no phone call, no
rights.

Jim places his pencil down and takes his glasses off.

JIM
You have no idea the heap of
trouble you've gotten yourself
into, have you?

NICK
You have no idea who my--

Nervon walks in and towards the desk with a cup of coffee.

JIM
Who your father is? We do and we
don't care. See that gentlemen with
the standard issue 9mm Baretta
attached to his hip? They call him
the Beaver Buster.

Nervon drops the coffee off and backs up into the corner with
his own notepad.

JIM (CONT'D)
Funniest goddamn nickname I've
heard in years. And you? You're the
Beaver.

Jim slides the coffee over to Nick, who takes a sip.

NICK
A little dirty, don't you think?

JIM
Well, his job is dirty. Now, you--
(reads report)
--a Mister Nickolas Frazee. Nick
Frazee, ooh, I like that. I don't
know what it is about a good
sounding name...

NERVON

It does have a good ring to it--

Nervon starts writing furiously in his own notepad.

JIM

Shush it, Nervon.

(to Nick)

Now, you, Mr. Nick Frazee, are less than a nobody. See this file?

Jim slides a folder two inches towards Nick.

JIM (CONT'D)

This is you. You are what we call a sub-non, which stands for sub-non-important. That means you are literally below a nobody in our system.

NICK

Yet, here I am.

Jim smiles.

JIM

Yet, here you are.

Beat.

Jim goes for a handshake.

JIM (CONT'D)

Well, I guess congratulations are in order. You'll probably be bumped up to non-important by the end of today.

NICK

I'm sorry. Am I in trouble?

Nervon, still writing furiously, smirks behind Jim.

Jim goes back to his own notepad.

JIM

Not many people believe in almost any conspiracy theory. Like at all.

(to Nervon)

What's the numbers, Nervon? Less than 1% of the population?

NERVON

Yes, sir.

JIM

And within that 1%, maybe point zero, zero, zero, zero, zero one percent truly believe.

NICK

And I'm in that sub-fraction?

Jim looks up at Nick.

JIM

Oh no, you are what we call a Beaver. You are in the sub-fraction of that sub-fraction. You not only are a true believer, but you had the will power to literally go out and dig for the truth.

Jim goes back to his writing.

JIM (CONT'D)

It's very impressive actually. And you did it without being affiliated with any news organization or intelligence agency.

NICK

I'm not really sure how that metaphor pertains. Beavers don't usually dig, do they?

JIM

All wild animals dig. The metaphor pertains because this majestically ugly, mythical beast is very adept at creating blockages in a very calculated stream of information. The enamel on a beaver's front teeth contain iron, which makes sense because beavers need to gnaw and chew through the trunks of trees, so their teeth have to be strong. And once they finish their digging and gnawing at this tree of knowledge, they use that information to create blockages in a multi-billion dollar stream of narration. A very detailed and organized stream of narration that is owned and operated by an undisclosed agency somewhat affiliated with The United States. And they do this through bundles of sticks and roots.

(MORE)

JIM (CONT'D)

A few sticks here or there are easy to push through. But when those sticks and roots are bundled together, interweaved together to create this almost impenetrable dam to our very detailed stream of information, problems tend to occur.

NICK

So, I'm in trouble.

JIM

Very much so, yes.

NICK

I want a lawyer.

Jim stops writing and massages his temples.

He lets out a chuckle.

JIM

You don't get a lawyer.

NICK

Bullshit. You're holding me unlawfully. There's been no charge. No judge. No lawyer. No face to face with my accuser--

JIM

We are your accuser.

NICK

So, what? I have no idea who you are.

JIM

I am Jim Jenkins, Chief Interrogation Officer with an undisclosed agency--

NICK

Somewhat affiliated with The United States. We are going in circles.

Jim chuckles louder.

JIM

Yes, we are. Now.

(softly)

(MORE)

JIM (CONT'D)

Now, if you're lucky, we'll pump you full of LSD, drop you off at the nearest police station, and have your parents come pick you up on your come down. Literally, no one will you believe you.

NICK

And if I'm unlucky?

Jim goes back to writing. Nervon writes behind him.

JIM

If you're unlucky, Officer Beaver Buster will take Mr. Frazee and chain him up to his steering wheel, make him swallow the key to get out of said handcuffs, park him in a garage and let him suffocate from the poisonous gas of carbon monoxide.

Jim gives Nick a quick smile.

NICK

And what, my father won't think my death is a wee bit odd?

JIM

Well, Stevenson writes a pretty good suicide note, but I think you're forgetting, that now only do we control the news, but we also control the police, who if I'm not mistaken, your father would fall under?

NERVON

Yes, sir, that is correct.

JIM

Shush it, Nervon. Rhetorical question.

Jim takes a big gulp of coffee.

JIM (CONT'D)

Now, it all really depends on how well and thorough you answer our questions, though.

Jim, writing again, pauses and looks up.

JIM (CONT'D)
So, may we begin?

Nick nods.

NICK
Sure, why not.

Jim goes back to writing. Nick grabs one of the smokes and takes a drag.

JIM
Wonderful. Now, we only have four questions that you need to answer. Who do you work for? Where did you get your information? What all do you know? And the names of everyone you may have told?

Jim, pen in hand, looks up for Nick's answer.

NICK
I don't work for anyone. I'm a student.

JIM
You don't have a side job? Or do any free lance journalism?

Nick shakes his head.

JIM (CONT'D)
Was this for a class or something?

NICK
No.

JIM
You haven't worked for any news publication in any capacity, ranging from full-story columns to tweeting or blogging?

NICK
No.

JIM
No blog?

NICK
No.

JIM
Everyone has a blog. You don't have
a blog?

Nick gives the smallest of head shakes.

JIM (CONT'D)
What about a vlog? No vlog?

NICK
No vlog.

Jim writes it down.

JIM
(to Nervon)
A true Rogue Beaver. We haven't had
one of those since 9/11.

NERVON
Actually, we had one in '07, right
before the housing collapse.

Jim peers back smiling.

JIM
Oh, right. I almost forgot about
her. God, she was smart.

Jim looks up at Nick.

JIM (CONT'D)
Not saying you aren't-- You know
what, forget it. This is good.
You're doing a good job.

Jim goes back to his notepad.

JIM (CONT'D)
Question two: Where or how did you
come about your information?

NICK
I came across an article on Reddit.

Jim writes this down.

JIM
(to Nervon)
That Reddit unit is slacking so
tough these days.

Nervon continues writing.

NERVON

Agreed.

JIM

And what did this article entail?

NICK

It was about how the SMC shooting was staged to help the president combat the issue of gun control.

JIM

It's always the gun control leakings. They really need to give up on it. They've been trying to disarm the populous for three decades.

NERVON

It's so silly.

Nervon smiles to himself as he writes.

JIM

(back to Nick)

And so you followed up on the SMC shootings?

NICK

Somewhat. It was talking about the fake crisis actors on the news. To which, I Googled other crisis actors and found a Justin Finder, I think?

JIM

(to Nervon)

Justin Finder. Well, that's the last time they use an American.

Nervon writes even more furiously.

NERVON

Yes, sir.

JIM

I don't know why they can't keep using the international actors. They literally know how to keep their mouths shut.

NERVON

The public tends to lose
believability when we go
international--

JIM

The public believes whatever we
want them to believe. Don't give me
that bullshit. If they question the
international, then just sprinkle
in a story about America the
diversified.

Nervon looks up from his writing.

NERVON

Yes, but--

JIM

The American public won't question
when they think they're being
racist. Foreigners are easier to
control, plain and simple. That
Finder kid has been causing
headaches from the beginning. You
fuckin' know it, too.

NERVON

Yes, sir. And Finder?

JIM

Send a response team to his house.

NERVON

Accident? Or--

JIM

Accident. Make sure all three
giants give a nice puff piece about
the grieving father who succumbed
to drugs.

Jim smiles when he stresses the word "father".

He looks up at Nick.

Nick swallows and stretches his collar a bit.

Jim gives another quick smile.

JIM (CONT'D)

Now. From what we have gathered,
that is the full extent of your
investigation?

NICK

Yes, sir.

JIM

Are you absolutely sure?

NICK

Yes, sir.

JIM

Good. If we find out you're lying--

Jim gives a maniacal chuckle and shakes his head.

JIM (CONT'D)

Now, to our final question. We know you tried to send this evidence into the New York Times.

(to Nervon)

Thank God Besos' team fuckin' found it in time.

Jim leans back and looks at Nick.

JIM (CONT'D)

Is there anybody else that you or someone close to you tried to send it to? We have all of the surveillance on you, already. We'll find it eventually, but it's better for you if you tell me now.

NICK

I-- I didn't send it to anyone.

JIM

Any close friend that we need to know about? An acquaintance?

NICK

No.

Jim finishes writing and closes the notepad.

JIM

Wonderful.

NICK

That's it? You just believe me?

Jim stands and starts to gather his things.

JIM
Oh, we already had pretty much all
of your answers. Except the Justin
Finder character.

With his things packed up, Jim grabs his coffee and takes a sip.

Nick still looks puzzled.

Jim smiles.

JIM (CONT'D)
We're The United States government.
This is really just a formality.

Jim gives Nick a nod as he walks out.

JIM (CONT'D)
Have a good day.

Nervon also gives Nick a nod and then follows Jim.

Nick sits back nervously and eyes the guard, Stevenson.

The door closes.

INT. UNDISCLOSED LOCATION - HALLWAY - DAY

Jim walks quickly through the hallway and stops at a security door. Nervon briskly tries to keep up.

NERVON
Sir. Sir, what do you want me to
tell the director?

Jim gestures to the door and Nervon gets his security card to open it for him.

JIM
That the Rogue Beaver is
neutralized.

Jim smiles, as he passes through a security door.

Nervon, right behind him, scribbles down in his notepad.

NERVON
An-- and the laptop?

Jim gives him a confused look.

JIM

Laptop?

Jim gestures to the next security door.

NERVON

Nickolas Frazee's laptop.

JIM

Oh, fucking bleach it, I don't care.

Nervon opens the door. Jim walks through.

NERVON

And the boy himself? LSD?

Jim thinks to himself, as he walks.

JIM

What? God, no. We already have way too many nutcases running around in this country. Give him to the Buster.

Nervon stops and writes that down.

NERVON

Yes, sir.

Jim keeps walking.

A WHISTLE starts pouring from his lips, as he heads through the final doors.

INT. GARAGE - DAY

Nick, handcuffed in a way to his steering wheel to where he can't reach the shifter, wakes up.

Exhaust fills the closed garage.

Nick realizes this and begins struggling to get out of his handcuffs.

He tries to reach the shifter, but fails.

Exhaust slowly fills the car through the vents.

NICK

Oh, fuck.

Nick starts coughing violently. He tries reaching the vents with his feet.

NICK (CONT'D)
Fuck, fuck, fuck.

He fails.

Nick struggles some more, but then stops. He quickly starts gagging himself.

DRY HEAVES

Nick keeps gagging himself.

He finally throws up, the key landing firmly in his fingers.

Hands shaking, he tries to unlock his handcuffs. His nose starts bleeding profusely.

Nick starts coughing violently.

He drops the key.

NICK (CONT'D)
Fuck!

COUGHING

Nick starts screaming. Tears roll down his cheeks, mixing in with the blood and vomit.

NICK (CONT'D)
Fuck!

Screams and cries come out of the violently struggling Nick.

CUT TO BLACK:

PART 3:

THE BRUTAL JUSTICE

INT. EINDRUCK RESIDENCE - NIGHT

Two bedside lamps light up the elegant room. Everything seems to be made of rich mahogany.

A 70-inch TV plasters the back wall. It shows various security camera feeds of the rest of the house.

JAMIE (25), dressed in an all black shirt and tie with white nitrile gloves on, walks through the various camera feeds before ending up in the bedroom.

ALBERT EINDRUCK (66), a white, balding, state supreme court justice, lies on the mattress in his tighty-whiteys with his hands tied to the bedposts.

Jamie sticks a needle into the frail arm of the old judge.

Eindruck wakes incoherently at first.

Eindruck
(semi-incoherently)
Wh-what is this? What the fuck is
this? Who the fuck are you?

Jamie cleans the puncture wound with an alcoholic wipe before administering a bandaid with a Smiley Face.

EINDRUCK
(slurring)
Why are you in my fucking house?
Get the fuck out of here.

Jamie pays the judge no heed, as he heads over to one of the nearby dressers.

EINDRUCK
Do you know who I am? I am a State
Supreme Court Justice of the United
fucking States.

Jamie unrolls A SLEEVE OF KNIVES on one of the nearby dressers.

EINDRUCK
You have no fucking idea who you
are fucking with. I am going to
fucking bury you.

The man in black silently prays, as he splashes water on his knives.

Eindruck struggles against the ropes, shaking the bed. He spits towards Jamie. Drool falling down on his chest.

EINDRUCK

(defeated)

Do you understand me. You are
fucking dead. Who the fuck do you
think you are? You better fucking--

Eindruck violently screams and struggles.

He again spits twice at his captor. Some of it lands on
Jamie's hand.

An insane laugh bellows out from the judge.

EINDRUCK

Do you know who I am?

Jamie notices it and flicks it off. He goes back to working.

EINDRUCK

(calmly and coherently)

I am going to fucking bury you,
son. Do you understand? Who the
fuck do you think you are?

Jamie walks over and gets right into the old man's face.

The two look each other square in the eyes.

EINDRUCK

I'm going to fucking bury you. I am
a State Supreme Court Justice of
the United States.

The man in black pats the old man's face.

JAMIE

I know.

Jamie grabs a napkin from the bar adjacent to the bed.

EINDRUCK

Oh, you know, huh?

Eindruck spits again. He tries kicking his blanket underneath
him, but gets nowhere.

Jamie heads back to his knives.

EINDRUCK

There ain't no place in this world
that won't know that face of yours.
You'll be dead before dawn. Do you
hear me? I've seen your face. You
are fucked. You're fucked.

Jamie sits in the rolling chair once more, wiping the spit off of his gloves.

JAMIE

Do you see a mask? On my face? No.
It's because I want you to see my
face. I want you to know who I am.

Eindruck laughs angrily and stares off straight ahead, as Jamie heads back to the dresser.

EINDRUCK

(calmly and to himself)
My security detail will be here any
minute. I can't wait to see the
look upon your face when they lay
the pain upon your body.

Jamie studies the old man.

JAMIE

They're not coming, judge.

EINDRUCK

Any minute. They'll be here any
fucking minute.

Eindruck chuckles to himself and looks directly at Jamie, who sits in the rolling chair, his leg crossed over the other.

EINDRUCK

I can't wait to see them pull you
apart.

Jamie winces as he cracks his neck to the side. He grabs his laptop.

JAMIE

I'm shaking, truly, in mah boots.

Jamie hits a key. The AC unit kicks on, while the overhead lights dim up.

The judge briefly looks up at the overhead lights turning on.

EINDRUCK

You hear that, I can hear sirens.

Jamie laughs this smoker's type laugh.

JAMIE

You don't hear nuffin, judge. I don't know if you've noticed this, but it is unusually hot inside here, isn't it?

Eindruck almost fully coherent at this point, looks around at his surroundings before fixing his gaze on his captor.

JAIME

Water?

EINDRUCK

Get to your point.

Jamie sets the glass of water down very peculiar-like on the end table.

JAMIE

(nonchalantly)

My point, Mr. Chief Justice, is that the security to get to you was quite remarkable, yes. You had a firewall, and a monitor, and an intrusion detection, and a crypto...

(laughs)

Such silly things. They probably sold you on these top of line security things, my guess for a pretty penny too, and either knowingly or unknowingly, not sure which is worse, so you can be truly secure. I imagined the state department ate it up too because you can't be having no winky dimblebat of a person threatening someone that at times makes very controversial decisions which can, on occasion, decide the collective fate of our society. And at times, possibly even the world.

The chief gives him a look of confusion.

JAMIE

We can't have all the crazy people killing judges is what I'm saying.

(beat)

They need to come to a decision freely, without any fear of retaliation.

EINDRUCK
I've lost interest, boy.

Jamie drags the computer chair next to the bedside table and places it in a very peculiar-like manner.

JAMIE
Blackmail, judge. Extortion. The trademarks of corruption. I'm saying you don't hear sirens. I'm saying the reason this room is hot is because there was a vulnerability within your security system in your home and it was through the A/C unit.

Jamie leans back to his knives on the dresser and picks up a 17 INCH FIXED-BLADE BOWIE HUNTING KNIFE, admiring it as if it's the first time he's ever laid eyes upon it.

JAMIE
Ah, smart houses. The Book of Isiah Chapter 54, Verse 17. No weapon that is formed against thee...

A hearty laugh booms out from the man in black.

JAMIE
(talks to himself mostly)
Don't get me wrong, it was a very thorough alarm system. Phishing after phishing to not only get into the AC company, but also into your security detail, as well. Everyone has a pressure point.
(looks to judge)
The only way it wouldn't work was if there weren't any guards on duty, which should mean that it should always work because you always have two guards on duty, watching you at all times.
Except...

EINDRUCK
Except where are the guards?

Jamie places the very sharp, very long knife on the bedside table and then sits back smiling.

JAMIE

Where indeed? It's interesting going through this assignment because it makes one realize what true motivation looks like. See, the same blackmail that you have on your security detail is the same blackmail we now have on your security detail. Your blackmail is our blackmail. So the greatest motivation for the human soul isn't money, or drugs, or sex, or vices.

(beat)

It is when you have been enslaved and have been offered the chance at freedom. Freedom is our greatest motivator in this world.

Jamie and Eindruck freeze in their place.

INT. THEATRE - NIGHT

A projection screen slides down at the front of the stage that Eindruck and Jamie are acting out upon. The following scene is played on video on the large projection screen before a small, dispersed crowd of wealthy elite in the theatre.

INT. CABIN - DAY

YOUNG JAMIE (9), HANNAH (7), AND DAVID (11) sit before a folded-up table, as BOBI (45), their stepfather, stands before them.

All three children scribble on pieces of papers.

Bobi looks down at his watch.

BOBI

60 seconds.

David glances over at Hannah's paper, as he counts on his fingers.

Bobi grabs his pencil and throws it against the wall.

BOBI

Run.

David curses underneath his breath.

Bobi crosses his arms -- his thick mustache twitching ever so slightly.

He watches Jamie and Hannah continue writing.

BOBI
(glances toward David)
Seven minutes, David.
(to Jamie and Hannah)
30 seconds.

Jamie focuses on his paper, as he notices Hannah place her pencil down.

Bobi squats down before Jamie. The old man sees the panic on the young boy's face.

BOBI
Focus. This isn't a race against
your sister. She is on your side.
Focus.

Jamie continues working the problems.

BOBI
Ten seconds.

Jamie glances up at Bobi before finishing up.

BOBI
Five, four, three, two, one. Time's
up.

Jamie sits back defeated. Bobi looks over his paper.

BOBI
35 equals...

Hannah quickly counts on her fingers the binary equivalent.

Hannah
100011.

BOBI
1011 x 111 equals...

HANNAH
1001101.

Bobi looks over at Jamie, care seeping from his eyes.

BOBI
Go run.

Jamie gets up and walks out.

INT. EINDRUCK RESIDENCE - NIGHT

The screen slides back up. Eindruck and Jamie resume from their previous frozen positions.

EINDRUCK

So, now that we're in this predicament, who exactly are you?

JAMIE

I, Mr. Supreme Court Justice of the STATE of Nevada, am the person who is going to change your life. I am the man that is going to give you this epiphany that you have been needing for so, so long. More importantly I represent Death. Or your subconscious. I'm not quite sure.

The judge looks down at the knife.

JAIME

I, for lack of a better word, am Justice. But you? You may call me Jamie, which is in fact my given name. Named after my crazy uncle, who is, ironically, an attorney for the British Accreditation Registry.

EINDRUCK

Justice. You think I'm intimidated by lunatics like you? With no respect for the law.

(spits again)

I'd rather fucking die.

Jamie pulls out a handkerchief and wipes his face.

EINDRUCK

Go ahead, asshole. Kill me already. I can't wait. Just the thought of you getting lethal injection for killing me is almost turning me on. I almost got a half chub. And you know what? I hope it's one of those fucking botched executions where they fuck up the canisters and you just suffer and suffer and suffer...

Jamie folds his handkerchief and puts it back into his pocket.

JAMIE

Are you finished? We have important things to discuss. We can't be yappin' on and on until the cows come home.

EINDRUCK

I don't know what the fuck you think you can get from me, but just know I am not going to give you shit, asshole. So, you might as well go ahead and kill me.

Jamie points his knife at him.

JAMIE

See I thought you might say something like that. On the tell-a-vision, you look like one of them real stubborn types. You know what I mean?

Jamie slides over and grabs his laptop and begins typing.

JAMIE

So, to combat that issue, I needed a wee bit of leverage.

Jamie hits a key and looks up at the TV.

JAMIE

Oops.

Jamie grabs the remote on the bed and switches the channel.

He switches it from one of the feeds to another. It shows an old lady tied to a chair, wincing in pain.

JAMIE

(shaking head)

The wives. Isn't it crazy that you have security cameras in almost every room of your eight bedroom, six bathroom house. It's kind of gross really. I'm assuming that is to keep tabs on you. Make sure you are doing what is assigned. Was that your idea or your handler's?

EINDRUCK

What do you want?

JAMIE

Now, is that or is that not your wife, Lynn Grace, of 43 years?

EINDRUCK

It is.

JAMIE

And is she tied up and struggling?

EINDRUCK

She is.

JAMIE

So, do I now have your attention?

Focused anger seethes from Eindruck.

EINDRUCK

For the moment.

JAMIE

That's good. That's good, Judge. See, you're learning already. What I want is, see, you, as a State Supreme Court Justice of the United STATES, you have a lot of authority. You have a lot of power. A lot of sway, so to speak.

Jamie, with the remote, waves his hands over his head, then turns off the TV.

JAMIE

I'm going about this the wrong way.

He places the remote next to the knife.

JAMIE

What I don't want, Judge, is to kill you. I don't want to kill you. I don't want to go into the next room, your second upstairs living room, and kill your wife. And I don't want to have to drive all the way to Maryland and stab your daughter to death. Because although she may be complicit in a lot of your wrongdoings, she is also a victim as well. That one will be a very hard decision to make. I don't want to do any of that.

Jamie readjusts in his seat.

JAMIE

See, you hold a lot of power as a Supreme Court Justice and I just want -- what I want -- is an honest discussion, an honest debate. By the end of the night, I want to -- hopefully -- have convinced you about certain social injustices in these united States of America. I want to affect your way of thinking and then set you free upon the murderous rampaging policies enacted by unregistered foreign agents. That's what I truly want and that's why I don't want to kill you. If I kill you, it will change nothing. If anything it will just exacerbate the issue at hand.

Jamie leans forward and grasps the judges's tied up hand again.

JAIME

But, if I change your mind, and send you on your way, the authority that you carry that swings between your legs like a 20-foot python might actually do some gosh dang good in this world. That's what I want, Judge. I want us to work together.

EINDRUCK

Okay. Okay, let's do it. Tell me what to do.

Jamie looks the judge over, as if gauging his honesty, and puts on his reading glasses.

JAMIE

How many cases, not counting the Nevada State Supreme Court, have you ruled over? Estimated.

Eindruck scowls toward Jamie, as he cracks his neck once more.

JAIME

Focus, Judge.

EINDRUCK

21,469.

Jamie raises an eyebrow.

EINDRUCK

My career is my legacy.

JAMIE

You know what, I can respect that. There was this one time, when I was working at a local grocery as this stock boy, my manager comes up to me--

Jamie laughs.

JAMIE

She actually reminded me of my mother, always kinda giving people shit. Especially with me. Always giving me shit about how hard I was working. What did she say, "You don't have to be working so hard. This job isn't that important." I replied with, "You know what Mary." Her name was Mary. I said, "You know what Mary, I take my job very seriously." And she kind of laughed at me and walked away. But, she stopped laughing and looked back, just standing there. She was so funny.

Jamie grabs his water.

JAMIE

Anyways, I'm going off on a tangent. There is one specific case, well two really, that you have resided over that have really been picking at me over the years.

EINDRUCK

Over the years?

JAMIE

Oh, yes. They have been bothering me for quite some time. I even remember reading on the news when I was seventeen when you had your heart attack. I became so distraught because of that, that all my friends thought I had mono.
(laughs)

I prayed, I literally prayed to a God that I didn't really believe existed at the time, to keep you alive.

(MORE)

I got down on my knees and I cried
and I prayed. You were not supposed
to die that day. And here we are.

Eindruck shifts uncomfortably in his bed at Jamie's creepily
normal laugh.

JAMIE

One of your cases involved a meth-
head 38 year old woman, and her
meth-head lover, beating her
redneck drug lord son to a pulp,
and leaving him chained up to a
rusted down piece o' shit Chevy
Camaro. You remember this case,
judge?

EINDRUCK

I remember all of my cases.

JAMIE

But do you remember this one?

EINDRUCK

Yes.

JAMIE

Everyone knows there is a lot of
open land in Nevada. People have
been leaving bodies there forever.
It is just a huge trafficking
warehouse. It's just this perfect
sanctuary for the criminal
underground. You wouldn't even have
to bury them. People will never
hear their screams. People will
never walk across their bones.

Jamie takes a sip of the water and places the glass down in a
very specific manner.

JAMIE

Now, these two grotesque human
beings took a 20 gauge shotgun
(mimes cocking a shotgun)
and
(mimes shooting it)
shot him in the back. He's down on
one knee, with his hand moving
around this huge imprint in his
stomach. "You just shoot me?"

Jamie mimes a shotgun and mouths a gunshot again.

JAMIE

Takes a shot straight to the side of his face. They left this poor bastard in the 120 degree desert, with a fucking shotgun spray to his stomach and a shotgun spray to his fucking face, to die. Now, this fucking poor asshole somehow managed to survive eight days before some random dune buggy lady comes across him. This guy should have fucking died. Nobody really understands how he survived to this day. To this day!

Jamie gets really serious.

JAMIE

You gave those two meth head lovers six months each, with a year of probation. Six months, Judge, for premeditated, attempted murder. And what was your reasoning behind it?

EINDRUCK

That they were mentally incapable to withstand trial because of their addiction.

JAMIE

Exactly.

EINDRUCK

Nobody really cared about that case. The two sides, neither of them had any family and their only friends were addicts. Recovery felt more important.

JAMIE

But they weren't just addicts, were they, Judge?

Eindruck's left eye flinches ever so slightly.

JAIME

Yeah, you knew what they were. You knew drugs weren't the only thing they dealt. Was this the beginning of the cover-up or the start of the blackmail>

EINDRUCK

I am a man of Law.

Jamie studies over Enidruck once more.

JAMIE
Interesting.

Eindruck and Jamie freeze in their positions.

INT. THEATRE - NIGHT

The projection screen comes down again.

EXT. WOODS - DAY

Bushes fill the ground beneath the trees. Birds sound off in the distance. The camera holds on the same bush for a long beat before we finally see a flicker of movement.

Jamie (13), in a ghillie suit, glances toward David (15) 5 yards away, also hidden in the bushes.

David adjusts slightly where he's positioned.

Both carry rifles.

David pulls down his hood, wiping sweat from his brow. He pulls out his canteen.

Jamie scans the trees frantically, muttering under his breath.

David takes a sip, as Jamie sees a flash of movement between the trees.

Hannah (11) sprints toward David and unleashes four quick shots from her handgun. Paint splatters David across his chest twice, and once in his face before Hannah launches herself at him, pulling out a rubber knife and stabbing him three times in succession.

She rolls across out of Jamie's sight, paint balls splattering the trees around her. She goes back for her handgun, but Jamie shoots her away from it.

David lies on his back. He sits up and throws off his goggles.

DAVID
Fuck.

Jamie's breathing intensifies, as he scans the trees.

David sits cross-legged, playing with the twigs before him.

Jamie scrambles to relocate.

Hannah comes flying from Jamie's right.

Jamie rolls to his left, aims, but is a half second too late, as Hannah is already on top of him.

Jamie disarms Hannah's knife, and kicks her square in the chest. She violently coughs. Jamie looks concerned, as Bobi comes from his left.

Jamie tries to pull out his own knife, but it is kicked away. He blocks kick after kick from Bobi before taking a right palm to the face.

Jamie blacks out.

Jamie comes to and looks up at Bobi. Hannah and David sit behind him.

He spits out blood as he sits up.

BOBI
What occurred?

Jamie looks over at David before looking back at the ground.

JAIME
Broke visual protocol.

Bobi scuffs his right thigh quickly and violently, as if he had a bug on his leg.

BOBI
Wrong.

Beat.

Jamie
Hesitation.

Bobi nods his head.

BOBI
Good. If you succeed individually,
you will succeed as a team. No
hesitation. Eyes up. Eyes focused.
Now, go run.

Bobi spits to the side, as the children get up to go run.

INT. EINDRUCK RESIDENCE - NIGHT

Eindruck and Jamie resume their positions.

The restraint on one of the judge's hands starts slipping.

Jamie doesn't seem to notice.

Jamie
What was your very next case?

EINDRUCK
It was a fraud embezzlement case.

JAMIE
Correct, Judge. Now, do you know
Lawrence Kohlberg's theory on Moral
Development?

Jamie gets up to walk around the room.

EINDRUCK
I may have heard something.

Eindruck tries to sneak out of one his restraints.

JAMIE
There are three stages in
Kohlberg's theory. The first stage,
pre-conventional is what all
children go through. In this stage
what is right for them is what they
can get away with. Almost all
aspects of their moral reasoning is
dictated by whether they will be
punished or rewarded. They won't
take that toy not because it is
wrong, but because they will get in
trouble by their parents. They
often try to push the limits to see
what they can get away with--

EINDRUCK
(hesitatingly)
Sounds correct.

Jamie walks around the front of the bed, mostly saying this
information to himself.

JAMIE
Now, almost all kids grow out of
this stage and into the second
stage, conventional.
(MORE)

This stage usually starts at adolescence and continues on for the rest of their lives. Almost everybody stays in this stage. In this stage, people do what is right because that is what society has dictated. They don't steal something or hurt someone because it is against the LAW that society has agreed upon, and only because of that. They must follow the law because it is important to follow the law for a society to function properly. They don't break any laws because if one individual does, then everyone will. They will follow the rules society has imposed upon them without question.

Eindruck's arm jerks slightly as he continues his attempted escape. Jamie notices and walks toward the bedside.

JAMIE

Now, the third and final stage is post-conventional.

He back hands the judge hard.

JAIME

You paying attention, judge?

Eindruck's dead eyes look squarely into Jamie's.

JAMIE

Very few people in the world actually make it to this stage.

The judge attempts his escape again, as Jamie begins his walk around the room again.

JAIME

A person's moral reasoning doesn't follow the rules of the land unquestioningly.

Jamie notices Eindruck has lost focus once more. He jumps up on top, straddling him, and back hands him a second time.

He grabs the old man's frail face. The two men look pissed at each other.

Jamie smiles forcefully as he holds the judge's face in his hands.

JAIME

I'm curious as to what you were planning to do should you have, in fact, gotten your one hand loose.

He stabs the long knife into the mattress and fixes the first restraint with an elaborate knot.

JAIME

Now, this third stage post-conventional moral alignment. They do what they believe is ethical, which at times could go against what society has deemed right or legal. Does that make sense?

Jamie begins re-tying Reynold's other hand.

EINDRUCK

What is legal is not always moral and what is illegal is not always immoral.

Jamie slides back into his seat.

JAMIE

Absolutely! Now here's the kicker. This level and the very first level, the one where the children do what's right not because it is right, but because they don't want to get in trouble, are almost indistinguishable. But, make no mistake, the last level, this post-conventional level is by far the most important. Following the rules of the land is of course, extremely beneficial to a society. Even having people blindly following them is important, but without that constant challenging, that constant questioning of why is this right to do? Why do we allow this? There's no room to grow. When we start blindly following along with what society dictates is morally right and morally legal, evil things tend to occur. Human beings in a society will do incredibly atrocious, atrocious acts based on some legality that society has dictated was morally valiant.

EINDRUCK

But, the rules of the land should be followed no matter what. If it is what society wants, and if they change it, then it is law. My hands are tied. I'm just the middle man.

JAMIE

Law does not change. Land, Air, Water. Law has been established from the beginning.

EINDRUCK

Land, Air, Water? Society dictates Law.

JAMIE

Society can be herded, like the chattle they are, into believing whatever their masters wish.

EINDRUCK

You're a lunatic.

Jamie lets out another laugh.

JAMIE

That's the second time you have called me a lunatic. There will be no third time.

EINDRUCK

Law is fluid. They are made to be changed as society grows.

JAMIE

What about rulings regarding slavery in pre-Civil War America? Or the Indian Child Welfare Act giving the federal government the authority to take presumptive custody over Native children not on Indian land in the early 20th century? Or mandatory minimums enacted upon the black population in the 1990s. Legalities passed by the governing body that the majority of people blindly followed. Statutes that were morally unjust. See, the third stage--

Eindruck

All Democrat policies.

JAMIE

Judge, you really believe that there are differences between Democrat and Republican politicians?

The Judge looks at him.

JAMIE

The answer is no. There are no differences between the left and the right politicians. Both sides designed to keep control over the population for the ruling elite. You know this, which is why you are so quiet at the moment. An entity that sees their future, willing to sacrifice anyone and everyone, to make sure they are still holding the reigns when the world wakes up.

The Judge sticks his tongue between his upper lip and teeth.

JAMIE

See, this third stage is what stands apart from the rest. Without that post-conventional wisdom to challenge the doctrine set upon the land, select groups of human beings will be gouged from the planet. Why? Because they're black. Or Jewish? Or gay? Or Asian? Or Native American? Or white? I scoff at the idea that society alone must be the absolute judge, jury, and executioner.

Jamie thrusts his hand down his leg like there was some disgusting bug on him.

JAMIE

Individuals bow down to mainstream thinking when PRESSURE is applied. This whole judicial system, the one that is supposed to safe guard the American people from the over zealous legalities passed through Congress, is flawed. It has turned itself into this money-making machine just like every other governing body.

EINDRUCK

I don't believe that for one second.

JAMIE

I know you don't. And I think that is one of the problems. With our current corrupt democratic capitalistic society, everything now is about making money and nothing else. We are no longer a Constitutional Republic because we have been force fed these lies from the elite that we are a democracy. Attorneys don't want to prove innocence anymore. They don't want a fair trial.

(excitedly)

They want conviction rates! They want to show their future customers how many deals, how many years they got off of their previous clients. They want a new form of slavery. American made products made for pennies on the dollar from what we have deemed our country's worst: the prison labor industrial complex. Do you know how many people pled guilty in all of their cases last year?

EINDRUCK

I do not.

JAMIE

97%. 97% of cases took a plea bargain to plead guilty to a lesser charge. They were railroaded into these agreements because the vast majority of people going to trial, wouldn't be able to afford a proper defense. Even though they have access to a public ATTORNEY. All of this happens because of the mandatory minimums our society has placed as the rule of the land. People are afraid of the huge sentence, even though a lot of the times, they would most likely win for the evidence gathered against them was bought and paid for by the ruling elite. Their tool, that you know and love? The ABCs.

EINDRUCK

What, the FBI? The CIA? I don't believe that for a second.

JAMIE

That's because you're thinking has stagnated.

Jamie and Eindruck freeze in their positions.

INT. THEATRE - NIGHT

The projection screen comes down a third time.

EXT. CABIN - DAY

Jamie (15) chops wood next to the house. David stacks the wood in the background.

Bobi walks outside and stands on the porch watching him with a blanket wrapped around.

Jamie doesn't look at him.

BOBI

A lot of anger pulsating inside of you, boy. I can feel it.

Jamie continues to ignore him.

BOBI

Do you want to talk about it?

JAIME

No.

Jamie launches the axe downwards onto his round.

Bobi takes a sip from his coffee.

BOBI

When I was little, my father used to come home piss-drunk every night looking for a fight. He'd take his belt and whip my mother across her back until she bled. Everywhere except her face had long drawn-out scars. Me and my brother would hide every time because that's what our mother wanted, lest he take the belt to us.

Jamie glances up before he swings the axe down again.

BOBI

So, one night, as I was hearing her cries, I grabbed the fire poker and walked down stairs into the basement. It clunked against each step. Clunk, clunk, clunk. He didn't even get up, as he noticed me walk towards him. He didn't see me as a threat until I beat him to death with it. His face laid all over the room.

Jamie swings the axe down again.

BOBI

So, I ask you again, what do you want?

JAIME

I want peace.

BOBI

By leaving the game?

Bobi looks over across the sky and the world.

BOBI

Peace is a dream only achieved when good men are willing to commit great violence upon evil men.

JAIME

Then, peace is one big cycle of hypocrisy. Good men eradicating evil, only to take their place in the end for their hearts are no longer pure.

Bobi contemplates the statement.

BOBI

Aye, that sounds about right. But someone must step up. You are not obligated. But the evil never leaves.

Jamie spits to the side as he places another log down.

JAMIE

Bullshit.

Jamie swings the axe down.

INT. EINDRUCK RESIDENCE - NIGHT

Eindruck and Jamie resume their positions.

JAMIE

Back to the very next case, Judge.
The fraud embezzlement case.

EINDRUCK

Yes.

JAMIE

Sarah Louise versus THE STATE of
Nevada.

EINDRUCK

That's the one.

JAMIE

A woman in her late thirties,
working as the financial accountant
for a multi-million dollar
nonprofit, the Whatcom Family
Resource Center, embezzles over
\$100,000 to pay for her gambling,
alcohol, and drug addiction.

EINDRUCK

Your point.

JAMIE

My point, Judge, is you gave this
woman five and a half years in a
federal penitentiary for embezzling
money from a multi-million dollar
organization. Do you know how she
got her gambling addictions?

EINDRUCK

Her genes?

JAMIE

The Clowns in America. She was
targeted. You know this because you
were targeted. She didn't want to
play the game. She didn't even know
a game was being played. You, on
the other hand.

EINDRUCK

I was going to go easy on her if she started to pay back the restitution to the organization before the sentence hearing, but not one dime was returned. I really wanted to give her the maximum of 20 years. She sealed her own fate.

JAMIE

Twenty years? The CEO of the
(air quotes)
nonprofit organization that was making over \$900,000 a year. The CFO making over \$500,000. Really, you should have given her a fuckin' medal. Just an over-bloated organization that pays the organization first and foremost before any funding succeeds in doing any real good. If they achieve their stated goal of helping families in need, then they wouldn't be--

EINDRUCK

The rules are rules. Context doesn't matter.

Jamie closes his eyes and shudders.

JAMIE

Context is everything, Judge. The surrounding circumstances are what helps define us as human beings. When you take away the context, you take away our humanity.

EINDRUCK

She doesn't belong in the same category as Human. I can't look at each and every case with all of the surrounding circumstances. It would take too much time. It would take too much money. Money, the thing that runs this whole planet?

JAMIE

The thing that runs you. That is exactly how you should look at each and every one of your cases. These people aren't numbers. They are human beings. Those two meth heads that you gave six months?

(MORE)

Their only family was the drug lord son that they tried to murder. Murder, Judge. All three have been in and out of prison their entire lives. The drug lord son ended up overdosing on morphine two years later, dead. While the mother and her meth head lover have been back in prison the last five. A bunch of patsies. The fall guys. You kept them out of prison because they benefited you and yours.

Jamie leans close again.

JAMIE

But, that Sarah Louise had three kids. She had two grandkids and a husband who loved her. I've talked with Sarah recently. I've also talked with the meth heads, but they didn't really give me much. Both of them were just these two fucking assholes. They had no remorse for what they did. Their only regret was not taking his head off with that fucking thing.

Jamie makes small GUNSHOT noise.

JAMIE

Mrs. Louise, though, she told me what she had gone through. It took me awhile to break down her walls, but she opened up a little. Guards not giving her clothes for two days. Women always trying to pick fights. Talking to her kids over the phone, hearing them cry. Heavy stuff, Judge. She had told me that she had even tried to kill herself when she was in there. She rolled up her sleeve and showed me this nasty vertical scar on her arm. Thick. She tells her family it was just this weird worker's accident. Can you imagine, though? Having your mother get thrown in prison, then having her commit suicide. Can you imagine that burden being put upon the children? You took away five years from this woman.

(MORE)

Sure, what she did was ILLEGAL, so to speak, but she never really hurt anyone, did she? No crime against the LAW was committed. No person injured. No victim. She was feeding her addiction, the addiction you and your people laid upon her. The exact same reason you gave just a minute ago on going so lightly on the ones addicted to certain illegal substances. All the while, her husband had three massive heart attacks, and two strokes. The children orphaned to the STATE. Lost in the system of hate. Otherwise known as Child Protection Services. Exactly what was wanted by the powers that be. But the husband survived. And came back stronger than ever. No, context is everything. No matter what. All the time.

Jamie leans back in his chair and pulls out a cigarette.

Eindruck lies there dumbfounded.

EINDRUCK

The husband survived?

JAMIE

The Brutal Justice. That's what they called you in your younger years?

Eindruck, distraught, nods his head once.

JAMIE

You promoted evil in this country, while disregarding the helpless. It sickens my stomach, Judge.

Eindruck sits speechless. He looks at Jamie and gives him a half-hearted smile, like the other half was just torn from his chest.

EINDRUCK

She wasn't targeted. She wasn't targeted.

Jamie stands quickly, grabbing the knife and gives the judge his cigarette, who takes a drag shakily.

JAMIE

But, alas, I think I may have
finally struck a chord.

Jamie gets on top of the bed, and straddles the judge. He
caresses Eindruck's cheek.

JAMIE

I'm proud of you, Judge. I really
am.

Both seem emotional.

INT. CABIN - DAY

Jamie (17), Hannah (15), and David (19) sit before a bulletin
board. Persons and corporations tied together by string lay
across it.

Bobi sits behind them smoking a cigarette.

BOBI

You're defeated. I know this.
Think.

DAVID

CFO of the Whatcom Family Resource
Center, Charlie Watson, formerly of
the financial firm, Loop Capital.
Before that, a washed-out recruit
for the clowns.

HANNAH

Attended Yale, graduating Magna Cum
Laude. Member of the secret society
Skull and Bones.

DAVID

The Pirates.

JAMIE

In-Q-tel, financial firm, financed
by the clowns, investments into the
four big social media platforms
before they took off, bought out
the creator of Digital Maps. Three
of the big four went to Harvard,
all drop-outs.

DAVID

All four founders have ties directly through their secret societies, which in turn tie back to twenty-two past presidents, and 408 members of Congress Inc.

BOBI

The corruption runs deeper than you could ever imagine. How do they get away with it?

The three look at their stepfather, as if waiting for an answer.

BOBI

Expand your thinking.

DAVID

Media. All forms. Hollywood. Television. News.

JAIME

The big six. Own over 90% of all news organizations.

Jamie shines his laser on the bulletin board.

BOBI

Don't forget the wives.

DAVID

Billionaires. Corporations. Tech. Media. Politicians. Courts. Police. All incorporated.

BOBI

What is a conspiracy theory? Define.

HANNAH

A belief that some covert but influential organization is responsible for a circumstance or event.

BOBI

Who coined the term conspiracy theory?

ALL THREE

The Clowns in America.

BOBI

Such symbolism. So public. What is a false flag event?

DAVID

A covert operation designed to deceive. The deception creates the appearance of a particular party, group or nation, being responsible for some activity, disguising the actual source of responsibility.

BOBI

What does it all tie back to?

DAVID

Money.

BOBI

Wrong.

HANNAH

Banking.

Bobi waits on her to keep going.

BOBI

Expand. Diction is important. Think Titanic. Why did they focus on a love story?

DAVID

To divert?

BOBI

Say your answer. Do not question your answer. Full send.

DAVID

To Divert.

HANNAH

To get the focus off of who died.

BOBI

Why must the ship go down?

Jamie nods his head as he starts to realize.

JAIME

To start the federal reserve. Marking the bank of America as a privately owned organization.

BOBI
Keep them dumb, drugged, and
docile. Who are sheep?

JAIME
The People.

BOBI
Who are the vampires?

DAVID
The elite.

BOBI
Who are the wolves?

JAIME
Politicians, aTORNNeys, Police,
Military.

BOBI
Who protects?

HANNAH
God.

Bobi cocks his head to the side, as he stares at Hannah. He
cracks his first smile.

BOBI
So, how do they get away with it?

Blank stares.

BOBI
What were they after? Think.

A long beat.

DAVID
Kids. They were after kids?

Bobi ashes his cigarette and looks up at the group.

BOBI
Children. Not kids. Words have
power. Why are the wolves after
children?

JAIME
The ultimate blackmail. Keeps
everyone in line with the plan.

Bobi takes one last drag and then puts out his cigarette.

BOBI
Is it just about blackmail?

The three siblings look over at their stepfather.

HANNAH
Sacrifices.

BOBI
To whom?

DAVID
Satan.

BOBI
Does Satan exist? Does the concept
of Satan exist?

The three look at each other.

BOBI
Where does your mother come in?

David shines a laser at a person hanging on the wall.

JAMIE
Charlie Watson.

BOBI
Expand. Your. Thinking. What was
their end goal?

JAMIE
To force God's hand.

Jamie stares at a photo of Eindruck at the wall.

INT. EINDRUCK RESIDENCE - NIGHT

Jamie and Eindruck resume their positions.

JAMIE
Do you Albert Reynolds Eindruck of
The STATE of Nevada, repent your
sins?

EindRUCK
I-- I do.

Emotion overwhelms Eindruck.

JAMIE
Specificity, Judge. That's the only way this works.

EINDRUCK
I... ask the Lord for mercy. I have taken bribes-- I have tortured and killed.

Jamie backhands the judge.

JAMIE
Specific. Be specific.

EINDRUCK
My bribes weren't just in money.

JAMIE
What else were you paid with?

EINDRUCK
Boys. I-- I was paid in children.

JAMIE
Very good, Judge. And do you, Albert Eindruck, ask the one true Lord for forgiveness?

EINDRUCK
I-- I do.

JAMIE
Specific.

EINDRUCK
I, Albert Eindruck, ask the one true Lord Jesus Christ for forgiveness of my sins against the children that I have raped and tortured and killed. I ask for forgiveness against my involvement into the continuation of the programs across the United States that aim to enslave humanity across the world.

Jamie stares at the defeated judge, satisfied with the response.

JAMIE
Then, I, James, Son of the Staff of God, Loyal Servant to the True Lord Jesus Christ, hereby sentence you to die.

Eindruck struggles against his restraints, spitting and muttering under his breath. His face slowly gains darkness, as his eyes turn black.

EINDRUCK
(demonic-like)
No. Nooo.

Jamie sticks the knife up through the judge's throat into his mouth. He watches the fear rush across Eindruck's face. He watches the strain leave his body. He watches the darkness disappear.

He violently stabs him three more times in the neck.

Jamie picks up the fallen cigarette and smokes it.

JAMIE
I just wish you would have figured
it all out before you sentenced my
mother to her suicide.

He caresses the judge's face one last time, leaving a bloody mark.

JAMIE
In nomine Patris et Filii et
Spiritus Sancti. All means all.
Nothing means nothing. We take this
journey together. In this life and
the next.

Jamie walks over to the bar in the room and washes his knife and hands.

He dries his hands on a very elegant, white hand towel.

He pulls out his phone and dials a number.

Jamie mixes himself a gin and tonic, as the phone rings on speaker.

Someone picks up.

JAMIE
Repackage the footage and upload
three days after the first story
appears.

He cuts a lime, squeezes it into his drink, and throws the lime in the cup. He grabs a small remote.

HANNAH
(through phone)
Understood.

JAIME
David, take out the daughter and
send to the big six. Start the
first narrative.

DAVID
(through phone)
Understood.

Jamie takes a long gulp and turns on a song.

The sound system shakes the room.

Jamie stands uncomfortably, as he contemplates the first life
he has taken.

He gathers his composure, grabs two knives and begins playing
the counter as drums, going along with the song.

He stops, checks his hair in the mirror behind the bar, puts
down one knife and picks up his drink. He heads into the next
room.

FADE OUT:

TITLE DISPLAYED ON THE TELEVISION - The Brutal Justice

ON THE TV

Jamie takes a sip from his drink and sets it down.

Jamie walks confidently toward Eindruck's wife, who screams
and cries at his approach.

He attacks her with the knife, knocking her and the chair
over.

FADE OUT:

PART 4 :

HAMMER

FADE IN:

EXT. BEN'S BACKYARD - NIGHT

In the middle of a carefully manicured landscape, a man stands before a diseased rose bush.

BENJAMIN BOAZ (34) holds up a fragile, wrinkled petal.

He rubs it between his fingers, disintegrating it into powder.

EXT. BEN'S BACKYARD - NIGHT

A tiny light at the top of a shed casts Ben's face in shadow.

With shovel in hands, Ben systematically begins to dig up the red flowers.

EXT. BEN'S BACKYARD - NIGHT

The dug-up rose bush, roots and all, sits on top of a slightly, worn-out tarp. Ben, in the hole up to his knees, digs deeper.

A small pile of soil builds next to him, as sweat begins to pile on his brow.

Ben doesn't stop. He moves like a machine, never slowing down, never speeding up -- always constant and consistent.

CLUNK

Ben taps the same spot again.

CLUNK-CLUNK

He wipes his sweaty brow with the sleeve of his flannel.

The young-looking man stabs the dirt one last time and pries up a black, metallic box.

Mr. Boaz picks it up, shakes away the dirt, and tosses it into the lawn next to the roses.

EXT. BEN'S BACKYARD - NIGHT

The rose bush sits neatly in the dug-up hole. Ben begins placing the small mound of soil back into its rightful place.

The hard, metallic box lies untouched and unmoved.

EXT. BEN'S BACKYARD - NIGHT

The rose bush sits replanted with a newly-watered layer of soil on top.

Ben stands at the shed, coiling up the hose with the same efficiency as he did with the digging.

The door of the shed stands open, showing darkness within.

EXT. BEN'S BACKYARD - NIGHT

Ben takes out a pouch of tobacco and papers, and quickly rolls a pristine-looking cigarette. A pair of leather gloves and some pruners lodge under his arm, as he lights up.

He smokes and trims.

He smokes and trims.

He smokes and trims.

His hand switches between the cigarette and the pruners, removing the dead and diseased leads, all the while removing the dead and diseased leads within him.

A small pile of the dead bush build beside him.

Using a rake, Ben manipulates the ground like a piece of clay, making sure every little lump of dirt is smashed down like the rest.

Mr. Boaz shakes the rake to free it from the small tidbits of dirt and picks up the shovel. He walks both into

THE SHED

Ben flips on the light.

Sitting on top of the work bench is a demon.

Gangly and gaunt, skin as pale as the moon, DANIEL REDIMIR chatters his long, pointed teeth together.

DANIEL

Sub Rosa.

Ben flips off the light and comes striding back, placing every step as if he owned the ground beneath him. He is a man of gravitas.

AT THE BOX

Ben squats down, hesitates, and then picks it up.

His hand slowly runs over the engravings.

Ben walks back into the shed, box in hand. He flips on the light once more.

Daniel, his skin tight to his skeletal frame, stands in the middle of the shed.

Ben sits at the one stool by the workbench. He puts on his reading glasses and engages himself into the lock of the box.

DANIEL (CONT'D)
Benjamin.

Ben glances at the door of the shed.

DANIEL (CONT'D)
They are coming.

Ben closes the door.

INT. BEN'S SHED - NIGHT

Hammers -- ball pein, claw, single jack, mallet -- hang neatly on the wall before him.

An assortment of other tools fill around them.

Benjamin turns on the radio. A sermon from the Book of Revelation plays loudly.

MAN ON RADIO
--your affliction and your poverty--
though you are rich! And I am aware
of the slander--

Ben turns it down and pulls out papers, tobacco, and matches.

MAN ON RADIO (CONT'D)
--of those who falsely claim to be
Jews, but are in fact a synagogue
of Satan.

Ben rolls a tight cigarette and lights it with a match. The black box sits locked on the workbench.

MAN ON RADIO (CONT'D)
Do not fear what you are about to
suffer.

He takes a drag and carefully places the cigarette on the
bench.

"3:36" is displayed on his watch.

Using brake cleaner, he sprays the entirety of the box, and
then the lock.

Engraved on top: "Attend to The Inane"

MAN ON RADIO (CONT'D)
Look, the devil is about to throw
some of you into prison to test
you, and you will suffer
tribulation for ten days.

DANIEL
Attend to The Inane.

Ben turns the radio up just one notch and spins the combo on
the lock to "07770".

MAN ON RADIO
Be faithful even unto death, and I
will give you the crown of life.

Ben opens the box, grabs the cigarette, and takes a drag.

MAN ON RADIO (CONT'D)
He who has an ear, let him hear
what the Spirit says to the
churches.

A Sig P322 .22 with a Rugged Oculus Suppressor lies in pieces
on a red cloth.

Ben looks at it, taking a long drag from the cigarette.
Daniel peeks behind his shoulder.

MAN ON RADIO (CONT'D)
The one who overcomes will not be
harmed by the second death.

Ben begins cleaning each piece one by one, taking deliberate
and efficient care.

Daniel hangs off the bench, his arms cradling his head. He
stares like a child in wonder at every part Ben picks up.

Daniel chatters his sharp teeth, like he's eager to take a bite.

Ben sprays the cleaner through the weapon.

MAN ON RADIO (CONT'D)
To the one who overcomes, I will
give the hidden manna.

DANIEL
This is a good look for you. I like
this new you--

MAN ON RADIO
I will also give him a white stone
inscribed with a new name, known
only to the one who receives it.

Mr. Boaz ignores Daniel and pushes a bore brush through the barrel.

Daniel looks to Ben.

DANIEL
It suits you.

With his reading glasses hanging off his nose, cigarette dangling from his lips, he looks over the engraving on the handle of the pistol.

"BBII"

DANIEL (CONT'D)
Benjamin Boaz the Second. Son of
Man.

Ben glances over his shoulder.

INT. BEN'S KITCHEN - NIGHT

The metallic box sits on top of the counter, a gaggle of dish rags thrown around it.

The news from the TV plays from the living room.

NEWS ANCHOR (O.C.)
--total number of deaths has
reached 66 in one night in Cave
Creek. The largest number of
recorded deaths since the Marburg
outbreak.

Daniel stands behind a squatted Ben, whose arm appears stuck in the middle drawer of a cabinet.

NEWS ANCHOR (O.C.) (CONT'D)
The good news is that new vaccine trials are underway--

Ben pulls out his arm. He grabs the box and places it into the drawer.

NEWS ANCHOR (O.C.) (CONT'D)
--with a potential cure to be available to the public by this fall. Stay-in-place orders are in effect starting Sunday.

He then folds each clean rag neatly back into the drawer and shuts it. Ben grabs the remote on the kitchen counter.

NEWS ANCHOR (CONT'D)
In other news, the Desert Cult Killers, as so dubbed by the social media sphere, are still at large after an upstanding Citizen and state supreme court justice and his family were viciously murdered last Thursd-

Ben pauses the tv as he walks into the living room. He lights up a cigarette and tosses the remote on the couch.

INSERT - THE PAUSED TV

A picture of Judge Albert Eindruck sits on the screen with the headline "The Desert Cult Killers"

BACK TO SCENE

Ben sits in the loveseat, adjacent to the TV, looking out the living room window.

The sound of crickets slowly encompasses the young man, who sits in peace in front of the emerging sunrise.

INT. NATALIA'S VAN - DAY

Ben sits squashed in the back middle seat of the van, with headphones in his ears and an apple in his hand.

His two male coworkers, BRIAN (40) and BRUCE (63), converse to each other around him.

BRIAN

--they picked a tackle who had
fallen out of a fourth-story
window.

BRUCE

If that isn't the definition of
insane, I don't know what is.

BRIAN

I mean, what if--

IN BEN'S EARS

Ben hears the mangled words strung together, with laughter
every so often thrown in between. No music plays, just the
sound of the apple crunching between his teeth.

Daniel sits on top of the middle console in between the two
seats in front and stares at the three men in the back with
anger in his eyes.

Ben catches eyes through the rearview mirror with his
neighbor -- the blonde driver, NATALIA (35).

She smiles. Ben returns a half-smile back.

Daniel mouths words endlessly to Ben, who pays no attention.

INT. NATIONAL LIBERTY'S ACCOUNTING SERVICES - DAY

Phones constantly RING, as male and female workers go about
their business.

Daniel sits leaning against Bruce's cubicle, which just so
happens to sit right next to Ben's.

Bruce and Ben work simultaneously on their respective
reports. Ben casually typing quickly and efficiently. Bruce
frantically moving with his normal, slow pace.

Brian walks up.

BRIAN

Why do you do that every single
day?

Daniel hits his head against the partition.

THUMP.

BRUCE

You talkin' to me?

BRIAN
Both of you.

Ben pays no attention with his earbuds in. Bruce waves him off.

BRIAN (CONT'D)
When I'm working I work but when
I'm not working? Pff, my e-mail
goes unscathed.

BRUCE
We weren't all given such apathy.

THUMP.

BRIAN
It gets tiresome looking at you two
on your break.
(to Bruce)
Why do you sweat so much?

BRUCE
I was blessed with big pores.

THUMP.

BRIAN
That's not a thing.

BRUCE
My doctor prescribed me a facial
cream to help close them up.

Bruce swivels his chair to look over at Brian.

BRUCE (CONT'D)
Well, and he also prescribed me
blood pressure medication.

Brian stares at him and gives a good hearty chuckle.

BRIAN
That's what I'm getting at though,
you guys look miserable. You
obviously need a break and Ben,
well, Ben's a--

INSERT - BEN'S SCREEN

BEN closes his spreadsheet and goes back to a news article.

"Russia, Syria, Turkey Mounting Massive Front Near the Polish
Border"

BRIAN (CONT'D)
--machine, but still, he--

Brian notices a plump lady, with thick, black-rimmed glasses walking down the aisle.

BRIAN (CONT'D)
Screamer. Inbound.

Brian scurries back to where he came from.

BRUCE
Ben, she's coming.

IN BEN'S EARS

Ben concentrates on the article, vaguely aware of the conversation taking place.

Bruce pokes his head over, trying to grab Ben's attention.

Bruce tosses an eraser at him, then quickly sits back down to work.

Ben turns to look, only to find MELANIE KAMPENERY (45) yanking out his ear bud.

She snaps at him.

MELANIE
Break time is over!

Ben turns back to his computer and switches back to his spreadsheet.

BRUCE
Ms. Kampenry, we, we had just gotten on our break--

MELANIE
Did I ask when you started your break? Get back to work, Mr. Humphries. Your utilization numbers have dipped three weeks in a row.

Ben looks down at a stapler and places his hand over it.

Daniel pokes his head over the wall of the cubicle.

MELANIE (CONT'D)
Neither of you have time to waste!
Get back to work!

DANIEL
Yes, Benjamin. Use it, my friend.

Bruce leans back into his work.

DANIEL (CONT'D)
Send her into the dark abyss.

Melanie squints at Ben's screen.

MELANIE
Serial Killers aren't of
importance, either, Mr. Boaz.

Ben takes his hand away from the stapler.

Daniel rolls his eyes.

MELANIE (CONT'D)
You can look up your gang-related
kinks on your time. Not on the
company's time.

Melanie storms out.

MELANIE (CONT'D)
Not on my time!

Ben gives Brian a quick little smirk and pulls the article
back up.

INT. PUBLIC BUS - DAY

Ben, biting his fingernails, vaguely reads the newspaper. He
sits in a window seat. Daniel stands in the aisle holding
onto a hand post.

An empty seat sits between them.

Daniel watches as a young woman with a beanie gets on the
bus. His eyes fixate on her as she contemplates every empty
seat before them.

DANIEL
Fall fast, tiny rat.

Daniel regurgitates a growl out the back of his throat as she
passes.

A small smile forms on his lips, celebrating his small
victory.

He looks back to the front and notices a frail old lady heading down the aisle. She smiles at all of the other passengers.

His eyes close.

Deep sigh.

OLD LADY
Is this seat taken?

DANIEL
Don't even think about it.

BEN
No, of course. Please.

Ben moves his backpack out of the way, so the old lady has more room.

Daniel clenches his jaw.

He places his forehead against the hand post and cracks his neck slowly.

EXT. BURGLIN STREET - DAY

Apartment building after apartment building line the small suburb.

Ben, with earphones in, walks along the sidewalk with his hands in his pockets, as the bus drives past him.

Daniel lurks along behind him.

The two come across a young man with baggy jeans and a red hoodie at the mouth of an alleyway.

Ben stops.

YOUNG GANG MEMBER
Keep steppin'.

Three other young men surround a woman in the alleyway.

Daniel crosses in front of Ben and stands to his left.

Both Daniel and Ben stare down the young man.

GANG MEMBER
What the fuck did I just say? This
doesn't concern you.

The gang member lifts up his shirt and places a hand on a gun resting in his waistband.

The smallest of eye twitches flashes on Ben's face, as he places a cigarette in his mouth and begins walking away.

Ben continues walking until he reaches the house at the end of the street -- his small two bedroom -- and heads up the driveway.

INT. CBT SCOTTSDALE'S WAITING ROOM - DAY

Ben sits on a suede couch. A round glass coffee table is littered with magazines before him.

Daniel stares intently at a tiny beetle making its way across a READER'S DIGEST.

The demon places his pointer finger in its path and watches it stop and change direction.

Daniel does this several more times.

RECEPTIONIST

Mr. Boaz, Dr. Brown will see you now.

Ben stands and walks toward the office as Daniel hops up off the ground and follows.

INT. DR. JANICE BROWN'S OFFICE - DAY

Ben sits on the three-seat sofa. Daniel stands on the other side of the couch like a protective butler.

Dr. Brown sits behind her notepad, looking at Ben under her spectacles.

DR. BROWN

Do you know why you are here, Ben?

Ben shakes his head.

DR. BROWN (CONT'D)

You recently had taken a randomized drug test from your employer.

Ben nods his head.

BEN

Yes, ma'am.

DR. BROWN

And that's the first one you've
ever had to take in all of the
years of working there?

Ben nods his head.

BEN

Yes, ma'am.

DR. BROWN

Is there anything you wish to tell
me?

Ben shakes his head.

BEN

No, ma'am.

DR. BROWN

Ben, this is a safe space.
Remember? I only want the best for
you. You can choose to not be
completely honest with me and I
will respect your decision or you
can talk freely with me. Let's not
forget why you started visiting
with me in the first place.

BEN

I haven't forgotten.

A long pause.

DR. BROWN

The randomized drug test should
have been flagged with Thiothixene.
Which in turn, should have been
reported to us to make sure you are
still on your medication.

BEN

Yes, ma'am.

DR. BROWN

Ben, schizophrenia can be a
debilitating disease, but it can be
treated. As you know, myself and
your superiors agreed to keep each
other in the know.

BEN

Yes, ma'am.

DR. BROWN
Are you still taking your
medication as prescribed?

Ben sits thinking. His breathing becomes labored.

BEN
No, ma'am. I lose function when I
take it.

DR. BROWN
I understand, Ben. Thank you for
telling me. I really do appreciate
it. But with schizophrenia, we have
to have an almost constant
vigilance. Any deviation could be
detrimental to your long term
health.

BEN
Yes, ma'am.

DR. BROWN
I'm going to prescribe you
something a little milder, but I
really want you to keep on it. Yes?

BEN
Yes, ma'am.

DR. BROWN
Do you still see Daniel?

BEN
No, ma'am.

DR. BROWN
Have you seen Daniel within the
past year?

Hesitation. Quick glance up.

BEN
No, ma'am.

DR. BROWN
So, Daniel isn't here today? In
this room?

BEN
No, ma'am.
(beat)
Daniel's gone.

Daniel stands back and smiles.

INT. BEN'S LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Infomercials play on the muted TV. Daniel stands next to it.

He watches Ben curled up on the couch, still in his suit.

DANIEL
(whispers)
Benjamin.

Brakes SQUEAL outside along the street.

Ben wakes.

DANIEL (CONT'D)
They are coming.

Ben gets up and walks to the curtains.

Ben peers out and sees a parked black sedan.

It drives off. Ben closes the curtains back up.

Daniel now stands behind him.

Ben quickly opens the curtains again and peers out. He walks to the counter and pours the new medication down the garbage disposal and flips it on.

He walks out onto the porch after lighting up a cigarette.

INT. NATALIA'S PLACE - NIGHT

Ben, Natalia, Bruce, Brian, and another man and woman sit around a large dining room table. They laugh, drink, and play two different games of rummy at the same time.

Dirty dishes litter the counter behind them.

Daniel stands next to Ben, frantically yelling into oblivion.

DANIEL
You have to stop fucking ignoring
me. They are coming, Benjamin.

Ben plays a seven of diamonds.

DANIEL (CONT'D)
I'm going to do it! I'm going to
break your fucking glass!
(MORE)

DANIEL (CONT'D)
You can't ignore me forever!
Fucking move it or I will fucking
move it!

LAUGHTER from the group.

Daniel looks violently angry as he struggles to move the wine glass. He spits and pushes and yells with all of his might.

DANIEL (CONT'D)
Your pistol can't save you! Only I
can save you! Please, Ben!

The table of people around him play on unnoticed.

DANIEL (CONT'D)
Ahhh! I'm going to fucking do it!
I'm going to fucking do it!

Daniel is on the verge of tears.

DANIEL (CONT'D)
I swear to God, don't ignore me!
I'm going to do it. I'm going to--

The wine glass begins to tip over.

Ben snatches it before it spills.

Ben picks his teeth with his tongue and cocks his head directly at Daniel, like a father witnessing his son do something incredibly stupid.

Daniel stands with his arms raised as high as possible above his head.

DANIEL (CONT'D)
(in disbelief)
I did it.

BRUCE
Earthquake?

BRIAN
Someone's had a little too much.
(laughs)
Man, you are cut off!

Ben looks away from Daniel and returns a laugh to Brian.

INT. NATALIA'S KITCHEN - NIGHT

Only the kitchen light is on. All of the previous guests have left.

Next to the sink, Ben dries the last of the wine glasses. Natalia leans up against the counter.

BEN

Thank you for dinner.

She briefly places her hand on his arm.

NATALIA

No, please, thank you for coming.
And for helping with the dishes.

Daniel stands beside the two.

DANIEL

I am Daniel Redimir. When they
come, they will pull--

Natalia finally gets Ben to commit to a full smile using one of her own.

DANIEL (CONT'D)

--your skin from your flesh and
burn your remains.

NATALIA

This doesn't excuse you from next
week's dinner. One every couple of
months does not count. No matter
how charming you may appear.

Ben raises an eyebrow mockingly as he places the final glass in the cupboard.

BEN

Charming? Me?

The two look like they might embrace, as Natalia gathers close.

BEN (CONT'D)

I should get going.

DANIEL

If you are lucky, it will be just
your eyes.

Natalia gives a slightly sad smile.

NATALIA
I'll walk you out.

The two stand at the doorway -- Ben outside, Natalia inside.

BEN
Once again, your cooking amazes me.
Thank you for hosting.

NATALIA
I was happy to.
(beat)
Tomorrow. 7:30. If you're late you
get left--

BEN
--behind.
(smiles)
I'll be there.

Natalia shuts the door.

ON THE STOOP

Ben moves with a little kick to his step and begins
whistling.

It's a slow tune, but it's whistling nonetheless.

He opens Natalia's small, wooden gate and enters his own
small, wooden gate.

Daniel, right behind him, stops and looks to the street.

DANIEL
They are coming.

He cocks his head to the side, with his fog-covered eyes
staring in one direction.

EXT. BEN'S BACK PORCH - NIGHT

Ben and Daniel sit across from one another, a small table
sits between them. Daniel stares at a focused Ben, who is
rolling near-perfect cigarettes.

DANIEL
So, are we going to sit here in our
own individual monologues for all
eternity, or are you going to
acknowledge the fact that I may
exist?

Ben glances in Daniel's direction.

DANIEL (CONT'D)

You can muster with all your might
in the entire world, you can put in
your headphones with no music in
the hopes of tuning me out, but
there is no denying the fact that
you can see me and that you can
hear me, while nobody else can hear
and see me.

Ben spits some excess tobacco out of his mouth.

DANIEL (CONT'D)

Benjamin, why are we playing such
childish games?

BEN

Why would I listen to you, demon?

DANIEL

Ah, there he is. It's been ages
since you have acknowledged me.

Daniel breathes in a mocking sigh of relief.

Ben focuses on his tobacco.

DANIEL (CONT'D)

Demon is just a word.

BEN

Ye cannot drink the cup of the
Lord, and the cup of devils: ye
cannot be partakers of the Lord's
table, and of the table of devils.
First Epistle to the Corinthians
Chapter 10, Verse 21.

DANIEL

For by him were all things created,
that are in heaven, and that are in
earth, visible and invisible,
whether they be thrones, or
dominions, or principalities, or
powers: all things were created by
him, and for him. Colossians 1:16.

Ben stares down the demon.

BEN

Now the Spirit speaketh expressly,
that in the latter times some shall
depart from the faith, giving heed
to seducing spirits, and doctrines
of devils. First Epistle to Timothy
Chapter 4, Verse 1.

Ben spits out a little tobacco.

DANIEL

All words, my friend. Technically
speaking, everything you think of
as real and external is all
occurring within your very own
head.

BEN

You are not real. You are not an
actual being. You are just a
figment of my imagination. My
imaginary nuisance God put upon me
for my past sins.

DANIEL

For all have sinned, and come short
of the glory of God. Romans 3:23.

BEN

You are not real, demon. Don't
speak your blasphemy anymore.

DANIEL

How do you know that I am not real?
Stop trying to hurt my feelings and
acknowledge our reality.

Ben ignores him.

DANIEL (CONT'D)

One must acknowledge the fact that
you do, in fact, witness what God
has put forth before you because
whether you like it or not, I am of
God's creation.

Ben intently rolls the cigarette.

BEN

You were not created by God. You
are a creation of Satan, sent here
to twist my mind to do for him his
evil bidding.

DANIEL

For his anger endureth but a moment; in his favour is life: weeping may endure for a night, but joy cometh in the morning. Psalms 30:3.

Ben lights the cigarette.

BEN

I will still hold anger for you in the morning.

The two look out to the setting sun.

DANIEL

Aye, that may be, but you can see the beauty of His powers all around us.

BEN

He must have had an off day when He got to you.

DANIEL

You are still thinking surface level, my friend. You must zoom out to see the bigger picture of not only external forces, but of internal ones.

BEN

Do not call me friend. I am no friend of the devil or his minions.

Ben ashes his cigarette.

DANIEL

Minion is a strong word. What's that verse about the enemy and weapons? Ah yes, "No weapon forged against me"--

BEN

Ye are of your father the devil, and the lusts of your father ye will do. He was a murderer from the beginning, and abode not in the truth, because there is no truth in him. When he speaketh a lie, he speaketh of his own: for he is a liar, and the father of it. Gospel of John Chapter 8, Verse 44.

DANIEL

And because I tell you the truth,
ye believe me not. Gospel of John
Chapter 8, Verse 45.

Ben looks over at the demon.

DANIEL (CONT'D)

Why do you speak the book titles
like that?

Ben takes a drag.

BEN

That's their name.

DANIEL

That's fair. You will never out
Holy Bible me, my friend.

BEN

Out Holy Bible you?

DANIEL

Yes, you will never beat me down
with scripture. I know it better
than you.

BEN

I know what you meant. Just an odd
way of saying it.

DANIEL

The jester is the only one that can
speak truth to the king.

BEN

Is that what you're trying? To
humor me?

DANIEL

The tension tends to subside from
the hierarchy once the king's very
own shortcomings are displayed
before his feet.

BEN

So I am the king in this charade.

DANIEL

And I am the jester.

BEN

And what you are doing is
displaying my shortcomings before
me?

Daniel smiles his gnarly-toothy grin at Ben.

DANIEL

(Nods)

Yes.

Ben thinks on the metaphor.

DANIEL (CONT'D)

If you take a step back and look at
this current conversation, you'll
notice that all of your anger,
aggression, frustration that you
have been applying to this world
and to yourself has subsided, and
we have only been talking for
approximately

(looks to the clock)

two minutes, and fifty seconds. And
I have called you friend twice.
Once was struck down. The second
wasn't acknowledged.

The demon and the man stare at one another.

DANIEL (CONT'D)

The truth is more easily ingestible
through humor. The jester must live
eternally, or hell will encompass
the king's reality. Suffocation is
a hard and lonely death. You must
come to terms with this.

BEN

So why are you here tormenting me
and me alone?

DANIEL

I am here to guide you to become
who you must.

BEN

And you have this guidance?

DANIEL

I do.

BEN

What about free will?

DANIEL

Free will is real. You can choose to ignore your destiny. My advice. But I wouldn't advise it. For the lesson will just be postponed to a later date.

BEN

So what's the truth?

DANIEL

The truth is you, Benjamin, son of Benjamin of the Boaz Family, chose this life of hardship. As did I.

Daniel chatters his teeth.

DANIEL (CONT'D)

We are God's chosen ones. You don't see it yet, but you will.

BEN

I don't remember this choosing.

DANIEL

That's the deal with this realm. You don't get to bring your remembrance. But scattered throughout your life will be bread crumbs to guide you to who you are supposed to become.

BEN

Bread crumbs, huh?

DANIEL

Each of the one True Lord God's most loyal chose this realm of hardship. Each with our own different individual sins agreed upon before entering, to lead those of us with similar sins to salvation. God asked who can I send? He asked of it many times. And every time, we all stepped up. Send me. Send me. And not in just a nonchalant manner. We agreed to enter this realm to experience the sins that we detested wholeheartedly. The sins that we spat with disgust, ensnared with a certain, almost questioning manner of our Creator.

(MORE)

DANIEL (CONT'D)

Of course, we would try to hide this distaste, but one can never hide their true intentions from the Most High.

BEN

So I am a chosen one of the Most High?

DANIEL

You are.

BEN

And what did I detest?

DANIEL

You were unique. You didn't detest per se. You wanted to guide others to salvation for you feared others would get lost on their missions.

Ben looks over at Daniel.

DANIEL (CONT'D)

So, I guess you're detestation was that of fear. You feared that the plan of the One True Lord God was inadequate. When in fact, He presented me with the information of what you must become before I ever was created. Long before you ever had your very own discussions with the Lord.

BEN

It all sounds so tiresome.

DANIEL

God is a jealous God. And He is a merciful God. He does not wish for any to go to the lake of fire. He wishes all of us to come back Home. So, us, as his most loyal, would say to him to leave these certain sinners in their filth and send them to the fire. That they are unworthy of the light of Heaven. Instead He sent those most loyal to experience these sins, to wake up, and then to save those also drenched in same said sins. It is a masterful plan. For He does not judge. The judgement comes from us. We end up judging ourselves.

(MORE)

DANIEL (CONT'D)

So you, who despises the powers that be that are controlling this world, experience the very sin that they commit, to bring those lost sheep out of that filth and into salvation.

BEN

So you were one of his most loyal.

DANIEL

I was thought of by our True Lord God before Lucifer ever had the thought of creating this realm. Our True Lord God has the patience of a highly trained puppy eager for his bowl of kibble from his owner. Salivating, but extreme patience.

BEN

So you and I knew each other before this realm?

DANIEL

No, I was a creation of Lucifer, who was a creation of the one true Lord God and his son Jesus Christ.

BEN

What of the non-chosen ones. What is their purpose?

DANIEL

The ones asleep are the ones that followed Lucifer into this realm. They openly ignored the One True Lord God. That is man's original sin. Turning their back on their father to enter into a physical dimension. The non-chosen ones are the ones this battle is over. To exit this realm and return to the One True Lord God, one must live a sin-free life, which is most improbable. Accomplished by only one, Jesus Christ. All fall short.

BEN

And since all fall short, their belief in Jesus is their salvation.

DANIEL

Correct. Like I said it is a perfect plan.

(MORE)

DANIEL (CONT'D)

The non-chosen ones must turn away from their sin, and find their salvation through Jesus the Son of the One True Lord God.

BEN

And my destiny is to guide others to that salvation.

DANIEL

Technically speaking, yes.

Ben ashes his cigarette.

BEN

What about non-technically speaking?

DANIEL

You are the Hammer. Designed by the One True Lord God and his son Jesus Christ to crush the cabal. And from their destruction, emerges Truth. And the Truth shall set many of those still sleeping free. There are many chosen ones set upon this path of destruction, whose sole purpose was to enter this realm and destroy the powers that be. Most are unaware, but are unable to ignore the sin set before them in their own respective realities. Some have the sole purpose of spreading the information for they don't have the same fear of sharing it. For others, they must act on the information. Few are like you. You may be the only one. I am not sure. I do know that the powers that be have been searching for you for a very long time. They knew one would be born in your birth year and that this one would carry the power of destruction.

(beat for Ben to catch up)

Most of the chosen ones will end in martyrdom, for the extreme is what will wake up the lost sheep.

A stillness encompasses Ben at the sound of martyrdom.

BEN

And what of the Book of Revelation?

DANIEL

The cabal of this world is already starting to crumble. The entrenchment runs deep. It must crumble and weaken. And out of their destruction, Satan will take the stage. The snake **must** be weakened before the war of all wars.

Ben puts his cigarette out.

BEN

So if I'm the hammer, what are you?

Daniel gives his first genuine smile, like a father would give his son after learning something new.

DANIEL

I am the wedge that helps you split it all apart.

Daniel lifts up his forearm to show him a perfect equilateral triangle.

Ben lifts his arm up to see the same triangle on his.

INT. MEDICAL CLINIC BATHROOM - SUNSET

Daniel sits on a sink with his legs crossed, whistling the same slow tune Ben whistled the other night.

The sound of urine mixes between hitting a cup and hitting the water in the toilet.

It is a long drawn out pee.

Daniel glances at Ben waiting for him to be done.

DANIEL

What are you going to tell them when they find out you haven't been taking your new meds?

Ben flushes and gathers his things together.

BEN

I'll handle it when it comes to that. Do you mind?

Daniel jumps off the sink and allows Ben to wash his hands.

EXT. MEDICAL CLINIC BATHROOM - SAME TIME

A nurse waits beside the door. She listens in on Ben talking to himself.

She looks down at his file.

"Suffers from schizophrenia. Hallucinations."

INT. MEDICAL CLINIC BATHROOM - SAME TIME

Ben readjusts his tie.

DANIEL

Why did you decide to flag yourself
in the system?

BEN

What do you mean?

DANIEL

You flagged yourself in the system.
And then you stopped taking your
medications.

Ben ignores his question.

DANIEL (CONT'D)

You knew they would come.

BEN

I thought you knew everything
already.

DANIEL

I know what I need to know. I do
not know the full plan. No one, but
the One True...

BEN

Lord God. Yeah, I got that.

DANIEL

So quick to anger with you.

BEN

Anger can be righteous.

Ben grabs the cup and walks out right into the nurse. Ben awkwardly hands it to her.

NURSE

Thank you, Mr. Boaz.

Ben nods and walks past.

BEN
(to Daniel)
Come on.

Daniel gives his death stare at the young lady.

EXT. BURGLIN STREET - NIGHT

Ben walks ahead of Daniel.

DANIEL
Are we going to talk about your
plan?

BEN
No plan.

DANIEL
Do you think that is wise?

Ben begins whistling.

DANIEL (CONT'D)
Benjamin.

BEN
I thought you were here to guide
me.

DANIEL
I am. To a plan of action.

Ben ignores him and continues walking.

INT. BEN'S PLACE - NIGHT

Ben enters whistling, with Daniel casually walking through the door behind him.

Ben sets his keys on the counter and heads around to the knife set, next to the cutting board

IN THE KITCHEN

A slight pause between whistling before the tune slows.

The middle drawer sits slightly ajar.

Ben places the serrated knife back in its place. He pulls out the three-inch pairing knife and conceals it in his hand, holding it steady behind his back.

Daniel, standing in the living room, looks around curiously.

DANIEL
That's different.

Ben heads toward the love seat, making the smallest of glances back behind him toward the kitchen door.

WHISTLING

Ben sits.

WHISTLING dies down.

A man, dressed in black with dark brown cowboy boots, leans against the kitchen doorway.

WHITE IRISH (30s) rubs his thin, nicely-trimmed mustache. He stares at Ben casually. A shotgun hangs to his side. Ben's GUN BOX is held in his hand.

Ben glances at him, but then turns his attention to his right and looks at another man coming from

THE SMALL BATHROOM

BLACK IRISH (30s, black) dries his hands with a small hand towel. Staring at Ben, he sucks in the two corners of his bottom lip. Also dressed in black with cowboy boots on.

Two holstered FN Five-Sevens make their appearance underneath Black Irish's arms.

Black Irish gives Ben a firm pat on his shoulder and walks toward the kitchen-counter stools. His twin crosses towards the couch next to the front door.

Daniel heads toward the vacant seat next to Ben on the love seat.

The mustached man sits, places the gun box on the living room table, and grabs an apple from the fruit bowl in front of him.

White Irish chomps down on the Golden Crisp, the shotgun on the armrest. His seriousness doesn't change.

Ben places the pairing knife next to him on his own armrest in a very peculiar manner, and a cigarette next to it.

CHOMP.

BLACK IRISH
(Slight Irish accent)
So... Here we are.

Ben breaks his contact from White Irish for a split second to look at the twin on the stool.

BLACK IRISH (CONT'D)
I said, here we are, Hammer.

Ben's eyes flash white, then back to brown as quick as lightning.

Daniel's eyes do the same.

A small pulse vibrates unnoticeably through the room.

The frail demon's body relaxes. His eyes show excitement.

Ben rubs his face, the lightheadedness getting to him.

DANIEL	BEN
Yes.	Was that a question?

Ben glances at Daniel, then back at White Irish.

BLACK IRISH
There it is, you crazy fuckin' man.

CHOMP.

BEN
A lot of fire power in this room.

Ben focuses his attention on White Irish's shotgun.

BEN (CONT'D)
An AA12 Atchisson. Advanced primer
ignition? Yes, of course.

CHOMP.

BEN (CONT'D)
(points to Black Irish)
And you have not one, but two FN
Five-Sevens.

Black Irish pulls his guns a little tighter and mocks a pouty face towards Ben.

Ben bellows out a hefty laugh.

BEN (CONT'D)
So, what brings one fully-automatic
shotgun, and two cop-killers to my
place of property?

BLACK IRISH
We've heard tall tales, Hammer.

PULSE.

Daniel lets out a small laugh, as his body relaxes again. A small twitch causes Ben to bite his lip.

BEN
Tall tales, you say?

BLACK IRISH
Look at you. Tryin' so hard to be
something bigger.

BEN
(under his breath)
You don't know what you're talking
about.

BLACK IRISH
What's that?

BEN
I said you don't know what you're
talking about. Not even a little.
(beat)
She might though.

The smile washes off of Black Irish's face. He slides out a cigarette.

BLACK IRISH
She?

BEN
She.

BLACK IRISH
Do you presume to know who we are,
Hammer?

PULSE.

A hard laugh comes out of DANIEL.

BEN
Yes.

DANIEL

Yes--

CHOMP.

DANIEL (CONT'D)

Look at him with that smug face.

BLACK IRISH

Please, enlighten us.

BEN

You're a dog. Him. Dog. Chained at the neck. So, cut the bullshit and bring the bitch out.

White Irish places his half-eaten apple onto the coffee table.

Black Irish chuckles to himself and lights the cigarette.

BLACK IRISH

Dog. That's good.

The black man hands the cig to White Irish and then opens the front door, speaking German.

Ben tilts his head to the side to glance out the front door, noticing a gentleman with a gun holstered dressed in street clothes.

BEN

Pinal County Sheriff? Undersheriff too?

White Irish just stares at him.

BEN (CONT'D)

How many in the fraternity?

In walks an older woman of slightly-below average height, wearing a dark suit and sunglasses that appear way too big.

MAMA (60s) hands her handbag to Black Irish as she walks to the middle seat and sits beside her son White Irish.

A large purple scar is etched across her face from eyebrow to jaw.

White Irish takes a drag and passes it to the woman.

WHITE IRISH

Here, mama.

MAMA

(German accent)

Well, lookie here. Twenty years later and still looking the exact same. I wish I could say the same.

Mama takes a drag.

MAMA (CONT'D)

We were never formally introduced back in the day, although it appears you know who I am.

BEN

I know who you are now. You're name never came up back then. If it had, we wouldn't be sitting here today. Funny how that works out sometimes.

MAMA

But you do remember me?

DANIEL

Kill them, Benjamin. Kill them all.

Ben winces as he tries to ignore Daniel.

BEN

Bits and pieces. You were just the Order's lowly accountant back then I think.

DANIEL

Don't let this play out too long, Benjamin.

Mama purses her lips. Ben charms her with a smile.

BEN

The money guy always comes out on top.

MAMA

Do you know the gentlemen with me?

Ben glances between the two brothers.

BEN

(mocking accent)

White Irish. Black Irish. The Superfecundation Twins. Like the very first set. Cain and Abel. And most likely a handful of off-duty law enforcement officers.

Mama manages a smile.

MAMA

I always hated those names. Nothing compares to Hammer though.

PULSE.

Ben closes his eyes and cracks his neck.

DANIEL

Kill them, Benjamin.

Ben looks to Daniel.

BEN

Hush.

Black Irish snorts.

WHITE IRISH

Fuckin' crazy man.

White Irish asks for the cig back.

BEN

Why are you here? In my home?

Mama snaps her fingers. White Irish hands Mama Ben's gun box.

MAMA

You know why we're here, Benjamin. You don't get to take out half the West Coast operation and come away scot-free.

BEN

Long ago.

MAMA

The top doesn't forget.

Mama runs her hand against the engravings.

MAMA (CONT'D)

Attend to the Inane.

She opens the box and casually pulls apart the Sig and places the pieces on the coffee table before her.

MAMA (CONT'D)

Twenty-two caliber always seemed like an odd fit for someone such as yourself.

BEN

The same caliber as James Bond. I don't see an issue. If I poke 33 tiny holes in you, you will most likely die the same as if I poked 17 slightly larger holes in you.

MAMA

Hmm.

White Irish hands the cig to Mama.

MAMA (CONT'D)

The Inane. Such an odd name for a gun.

BLACK IRISH

Nobody names a gun, mama.

She closes the box and hands it to Black Irish.

DANIEL

All sound and vibration, my friend.
It's all sound and vibration.

Ben gives Daniel a quick glance.

BEN

I am nobody.

Ben's leg starts to shake.

BEN (CONT'D)

I'm curious, why didn't you come in with your sons?

MAMA

Partly because we've all heard about your tics and mannerisms and partly because I had certain business next door.

Ben pulls out his matchbox and grabs the cig next to the pairing knife.

BEN

May I?

Black Irish gives him a nod.

BLACK IRISH

It is your home.

Ben messes with his tie and lights the cigarette.

MAMA

I honestly thought we might get a bigger reaction from you.

DANIEL

A buncha vermin. Goat lovers.

BEN

I try not to let my emotions-- Dogs. Pigs.

DANIEL (CONT'D)

BEN (CONT'D)

--get the better of me--

Daniel starts snorting like a pig.

DANIEL

Pigs. Pigs. Pi--

BEN

Shut up.

Mama bursts out laughing.

MAMA

God, you really are crazy.

Ben stares at the woman.

BEN

Everyone is crazy, mama.

WHITE IRISH

You don't get to call her that.

BEN

How do you know she didn't have me as well? Two sons, two different fathers. Wouldn't be difficult to get another to squeak right in there...

The three intruders tense up.

Daniel bursts out laughing and begins to get excited.

BEN (CONT'D)

My apologies.

Mama puts her hand on her youngest son.

MAMA

No, no. I apologize. My youngest hasn't quite grasped the concept of civility.

White Irish gives Ben a death glare as he takes a drag.

MAMA (CONT'D)

So, an accountant yourself? It just doesn't seem to fit your... personality.

BEN

I can give you a whole office full of people who would say that it fits my personality to a tee.

MAMA

Killing was your strong suit, Hammer.

No pulse. Deep breath.

BEN

Killing isn't free.

DANIEL

Ben, this is only the beginning.

MAMA

That's what this is about. Money?

Mama scoffs at the notion.

BEN

I never said anything about money.

MAMA

The amount of time and resources we spent on tracking you down. Always a little snake hiding in the bush--

DANIEL

Don't wait, Benjamin. Kill he--

BEN

Shut! Up!

Mama laughs to herself.

MAMA

The rumors really do have some truth to them it appears. I mean there were so many outlandish things people told about you. You never knew what to believe.

BEN

Oh, yeah?

Ben glances around the room again. Black Irish signals for the cigarette. His usual joyous demeanor now serious.

MAMA

Just the usual nonsense. You yell at yourself. You move at impossible speeds. You have incredible strength. A devil inside you. But, I know the real truth, Hammer.

A small pulse comes back from Ben, followed by a deep sigh.

Ben's attention flounders around the room.

BEN

What's that?

Ben takes a drag as he removes his suit jacket.

MAMA

That you're just an efficient killer. Always have been, always will be.

WHITE IRISH

And now look at him. The infamous Hammer. Just another broken-down accountant.

White Irish breaks his seriousness and sends a dangerous smiles Ben's way.

BEN

The money guy always comes out on top.

DANIEL

We have no time for these imbeciles, Benjamin. The trumpe--

Daniel's back goes rigid. He stares off towards his left.

DANIEL (CONT'D)

Almost time, my friend.

Ben raises an eyebrow at his demon friend. He draws his attention back to the people in the room.

SIRENS play off in the distance.

MAMA

Look at you, fighting it. Why are you so scared of becoming what you are?

BEN
I am nobody.

MAMA
You're a killer, and it's your
addiction. And you are afraid.

Black Irish finishes the cigarette and dunks it in the glass
of water before him.

MAMA (CONT'D)
You're afraid of falling off the
wagon. You're afraid of killing for
some odd reason or another.

Mama flips her hair back nonchalantly.

BEN
Well, that's where you're wrong, I
suppose.

MAMA DEUTSCHE
Where?

BEN
That I'm afraid of killing.

An uncomfortable silence.

BEN (CONT'D)
Shall we get on with it?

WHITE IRISH
(In German, Subtitled)
The *broken* Hammer. Giving up.

Daniel turns serious.

DANIEL
(In German, Subtitled)
I can feel it, Ben. The anger.
These *kids* no nothing.

The demon holds in his breath.

BEN
(In German, Subtitled)
Nobody knows anything, my friend.

Mama and her sons glance at one another.

SIRENS grow louder and then stop.

Mama gestures to Black Irish. He pokes his head out gives a nod.

Ben lights up his cigarette.

BEN (CONT'D)
Do you know what a spirit guide is?
Guardian angel maybe?

Ben takes a drag.

The sheriff and undersheriff walk in the front, followed by two more deputies.

Mama shakes her head ever so slightly. The tide of power slowly shifting in the room.

BEN (CONT'D)
I remember the first time I asked
for my spirit guide's name. I was
ten, alone, sitting on my couch,
and I asked him what he wished to
be called.

White Irish slowly grabs the handle of the shotgun.

BEN (CONT'D)
You don't know fear until you've
hit that moment. It changes
drastically when you're alone.

MAMA
It?

Two more deputies enter from the kitchen.

BEN
Fear. And that was my biggest
mistake.

Ben laughs to himself and places the cigarette on the armrest next to the pairing knife.

BEN (CONT'D)
(under his breath)
You are supposed to call their
names fearlessly. Control. Yeah?

Ben shakes his head and gives a small chuckle -- emotion seeping into his eyes.

He regains his composure.

BEN (CONT'D)
 But, you walking in here thinking
 you can just control the situation?

Ben's eyes turn white as a cloud, DANIEL rigid as a board
 beside him.

MAMA
 (noticing the eyes)
 Interesting.

BEN
 I can't even control the situation.
 (to Daniel)
 Daniel.

DANIEL
 I am here, Benjamin son of Benjamin
 of the Boaz Family.

BLACK IRISH
 Mama?

MAMA
 Hammer?

A LARGE PULSE vibrates through BEN out into the room.

The nine intruders all react and look to one another.

White Irish doesn't take his eyes off of Ben, slowly pointing
 the shotgun up and at the young looking man on the love seat.

BEN
 When you hear rumors of the
 insane...

PULSE. Ben getting more tense, anger seeping from his
 inflection.

BEN (CONT'D)
 Of the Hammer...

PULSE. Ben intensely moves his body as if he's about to
 implode.

Mama tries to scamper towards the door, but gets entangled
 within the web of bodies in front of her.

Black Irish tries to usher her out.

BEN (CONT'D)
 Of the dead...

Black Irish pulls out one of his Five-Sevens and grabs hold of Mama's arm.

The rest of the intruders take a step towards Ben.

BEN (CONT'D)

You run.

A large PULSE knocks everyone back.

Ben forces the pairing knife from the armrest into Black Irish's throat.

Ben lunges toward the black man, summoning the knife back out of the throat.

He takes the knife and stabs three deputies before impaling the sheriff in the throat. He grabs a flash-bang from his waistband, as White Irish swings the fully-automatic around and fires.

Ben ducks and uses Daniel's force to push the gun left.

Multiple rounds land in the hallway, as a small force field entrenches the Hammer.

The remaining deputies fire upon Hammer.

Ben forces the Inane to manifest back together in his hand.

White Irish regains his footing and starts walking toward Hammer on the ground.

Ben absorbs shotgun shell after shotgun shell from the remaining twin.

PULSE.

White Irish falls to his knees. Ben shoots the three remaining deputies. And then shoots White Irish once.

Ben reloads and jumps on top of the white twin.

Mama scrambles around on all fours.

Ben sitting squarely on top of the mustached man, takes White Irish by the jaw, his arm outstretched, and shoots him in the cheek twice.

The undersheriff shoots ben twice in the back.

The force field comes back and stops the rest of the rounds.

SIRENS grow once more in the distance.

Mama grabs one of Black Irish's FN Five-Sevens and fires it aimlessly.

The small force field entrenches the Hammer again.

Ben walks through the debris, as the undersheriff struggles to reload.

BEN (CONT'D)
Look at you. You're heart seems
about to explode.

Ben summons the pairing knife once more into his hand.

BEN (CONT'D)
Ask Jesus one last time for
forgiveness and mercy.

Mama struggles to head towards the kitchen to escape.

UNDERSHERIFF
Oh, lord. Please, forgive me.

Ben stabs.

BEN
Jesus Christ, my lord and savior.
Please, have mercy on this man's
soul.

The body drops. Ben walks over towards the struggling and sobbing Mama. The empty Five-Seven still in her hand, clacking on the kitchen tile.

She lets out a terrified scream as Ben grabs her by the hair and drags her to the front. He stands her up.

He sees the life slowly drain from her pale face. He sees her fear.

SIRENS.

Ben, with the flash-bang still in his left hand, pulls the pin, stuffs it into her mouth, pushes her out the front, and shuts the door.

EXT. BEN'S PLACE - SAME TIME

Mama stumbles out sobbing, make-up smeared, flash-bang in her mouth, as more deputies look on in horror, guns drawn.

INT. BEN'S PLACE - SAME TIME

Ben pulls down with all his might, as if the grenade was attached to some invisible wire.

EXT. BEN'S PLACE - SAME TIME

Mama's entire body explodes. The windows shatter. The door decimates and then slowly falls off the hinges.

INT. BEN'S PLACE - SAME TIME

Ben, blood dripping from his hand, grabs the cigarette.

The demon relaxes.

Ben winces in pain as he stands and takes a drag.

BEN

The Gospel According to Mark,
Chapter 16, Verse 15.

DANIEL

And he said unto them, Go ye into
all the world, and preach the
gospel to every creature.

SIRENS.

The Hammer and the Wedge look out toward the deputies.

CUT TO BLACK:

PART 5:
LAUGHTER.

INT. ABANDONED APARTMENT - DAY

The front door shoves a propped-up mattress out of its way.

RYAN SKARPY (early 20s), dirty with a scraggly beard, maneuvers around the barricaded entryway.

Carrying an AR-15, he creeps down towards the two doors in the hallway -- one by one, he pushes them open.

Nothing.

Ryan WHISTLES.

DAVID SKARPY (late 20s), equally dirty, but with an even more scraggly beard, walks in carrying a bolt-action rifle in one hand and a 5-gallon gas can in the other.

David's nephew, SIMEON (2), sits in a hiking baby backpack carrier and sucks on a binky.

David gives Ryan a big, toothy smile and closes the door quietly.

INT. ABANDONED APARTMENT - STAIRS - DAY

A baby gate sits open at the top of the stairs.

Ryan leads the way up. David, with Simeon secured on his back, takes a knee in the middle.

Ryan WHISTLES.

David and Simeon walk up the stairs. They see a big couch, with pillows and throw blankets.

DAVID
Oh, yeah, this is very nice,
Simeon. Pristine, if I may use that
word.

Simeon grunts in agreement

Ryan turns the blinds and sees two cars parked outside. He hits David in the shoulder.

DAVID (CONT'D)
What do we got?

David pulls down the blinds, too.

RYAN
Gas.

David hands him the gas can.

Ryan sets down his pack and starts back down the stairs -- gas can and rifle in hand.

DAVID
C'mon, Sim. Let's see what kind of
trouble we can get ourselves into.

David collects some dust on the railing with his finger.

EXT. PARKING LOT - DAY

The apartments, the cars, the roads -- everything lies motionless, except the tress.

Ryan reaches the two parked cars facing the apartment.

He looks back towards the balcony. He sets the gas can down on the asphalt and the rifle on the hood.

Ryan tries the doors. Both locked.

He peers through the windows. Security indicators flash on both.

INT. KITCHEN - DAY

A thick layer of dust covers the otherwise clean kitchen.

Simeon, with binky in mouth, looks around from up top. David flips the light switch.

Nothing.

He places his rifle in a corner and starts opening cabinets.

David turns on the faucet.

Nothing.

DAVID
Course not. That'd be too simple,
huh, Sim?

SIMEON
Hmm.

He turns his attention to the largest cabinet and opens it.

Cans of food stack up high.

David stares at it in disbelief. Immediately, he takes Simeon down.

The odd man grabs and opens a can of peaches excitedly.

Using his dirty fingers, David stuffs a peach into his smiling mouth.

SIMEON (CONT'D)

Hmm.

Barely containing himself, he gives one to the child. David puts his index finger to his lips and watches as Sim takes a bite.

David lets loose after watching the toddler's reaction.

DAVID

(whispering)

Want so-- want some more?

David signals 'more' with his fingers. Sim copies and smiles.

SIMEON

Hmm.

David stifles a cough and continues to feed Simeon.

EXT. PARKING LOT - DAY

Ryan jams a screwdriver into the bottom of the gas tank. Gas drizzles into the empty, five gallon can.

Ryan gets up and dusts himself off. He grabs his rifle and waits.

To his left, Ryan sees another parking lot with more cars.

INT. CHILD'S BEDROOM - DAY

Besides the layer of dust and the broken closet door, the room sits impeccably clean.

David holds Sim.

DAVID

Ignore the crib, mah boy.

SIMEON

Hmm.

David opens the closet and finds baby clothes.

DAVID
Oh, very nice.

David rummages through the clothes.

DAVID (CONT'D)
Oh, very, very nice. What you
think? Frankenstein or tiger?

SIMEON
Hmm.

DAVID
That's what I was thinkin', too.

David grabs an outfit.

INT./EXT. NEW PARKING LOT - DAY

Ryan searches the inside of one of the cars and peers out the windshield.

He grabs his rifle and squats behind the car. Quick flashes of clothing appears in the distance next to a parked car.

Ryan peers out from behind the bumper. He slowly pulls up his rifle, looking through the scope.

Fog accumulating in the distance.

Ryan sits back against the car and throws out the dip in his lip.

He peers underneath the car and sits back up.

RYAN
(whispers)
Fuck.

He takes off his boots.

INT. BATHROOM - DAY

Sim wanders in before David and tries lifting up the toilet seat. David enters and flips on the light.

It flickers for a second, then nothing.

He tries the faucet.

Nothing.

David notices three toothbrushes. Simeon pulls on his leg and gives him an imaginary object.

DAVID
Oh, for me? Thank you. Good job.
Two time, two time.

Sim gives David two high fives.

David turns his attention to the tub and turns the faucet.

Water pours out.

David laughs hysterically.

DAVID (CONT'D)
Wha-- What! Simeon, look. It's
water. It's water!

David picks up Simeon and shows him the water. They both laugh.

EXT. NEW PARKING LOT - DAY

Rifle at the ready, Ryan heads down the parking lot towards the flash.

Creeping around the vehicle, he freezes.

At the other end of his rifle stares back two women.

One -- breathing heavily -- has her handgun aimed back.

INT. BATHROOM - DAY

David and Simeon sit in the tub full of bubbles.

DAVID
Can you say Dada? Dada?

SIMEON
Hmm.

DAVID
Can you say Uncle David?

Sim smiles.

DAVID (CONT'D)
Want some more bubbles?

SIMEON

Hmm.

Sim stands up showing his swim trunks.

EXT. NEW PARKING LOT - DAY

A plastic bag blows into one of the parked cars. Ryan and the two women are nowhere to be seen.

INT. BATHROOM - DAY

Simeon intently plays with the toilet seat again, wearing his new Frankenstein T-shirt.

David looks at the mirror in his own swim trunks, water dripping everywhere, with a new haircut -- a grey-scaled patch sits on his upper shoulder.

Shaving cream covers his face. Hair covers the sink.

DAVID

What you think? Mustache or no
mustache?

David looks intently at himself in the mirror and shrugs.

He starts shaving.

INT. BEDROOM - DAY

David, dressed in clean jeans, a flannel and suspenders, nicely folds clothes on the bed.

Simeon runs from the bathroom into the hallway. He stops, looks at David, and runs back.

David leaves a can of peaches on the folded clothes.

INT. KITCHEN - DAY

A bottle of bleach sits next to many pots of water on the hardwood floor.

Simeon plays with an empty pot and spoon, while David sits on his knees with a pot of water in front of him, stirring.

DAVID

That's right, gotta stir it right
up. Stir, stir, stir--

A door opens and closes downstairs.

DAVID (CONT'D)
Sodium hypochlorite, although a
powerful disinfectant, needs to
properly dissipate for it to work
its magic.

Ryan WHISTLES at the bottom of the stairs. The soft steps of
his feet noticeable as he climbs to the top.

DAVID (CONT'D)
(without looking up)
Where ya been?

RYAN
Stragglers.

The two women reveal themselves. David gives them a nod.

DAVID
Canned food on the table. Help
yourselves.

JASMINE (20s), dirty, grabs one of the cans immediately. She
opens it and starts devouring the food inside, not taking her
eyes off of the two men.

Ryan heads to the window behind David. David shoves a cup of
coffee into his hands.

LEAH (20s) stands in front of Jasmine, shielding her from
view. She holds the handgun at her side.

RYAN
Saw fog 3 klicks east.

David briefly stops stirring.

DAVID
Interesting.

Jasmine secretly takes another can. Her and David catch eyes.
David gives her a sympathetic smile.

LEAH
Why is that interesting?

Simeon walks over and hands Jasmine a napkin.

JASMINE
(quietly)
Thank you.

Sim puts his thumb to his chest, signing you're welcome.

SIMEON

Hmm.

RYAN

It's one of the signs of the Reaps.

Ryan turns on the faucet. Nothing.

JASMINE

Reaps?

DAVID

It's what we call the winged creatures. Laughters on the ground. Reaps in the sky.

JASMINE

Oh. We just call them Flyers.

DAVID

That's a good name for them, too.

RYAN

How'd you turn on the water?

David smiles at Jasmine and Leah as he replies to Ryan.

DAVID

Now, that is the most interesting question. This campus was built during the height of the cold war, which technically speaking is a misnomer. Every year could be considered the height of the cold war for every year had some potentially escalating tension events. The construction during this time period reflected that in certain parts of the country. Namely, the plumbing industry. No one lives very long without water, you see. So, they would often have a separate system just for the bath tub running off of a separate water source.

Leah and Jasmine glance at each other.

DAVID (CONT'D)

The power of seeing the unknown and communicating that to the masses. Truly remarkable.

David laughs to himself.

DAVID (CONT'D)
(to SIMEON)
C'mon, bud. Time for night night.

David picks Sim up away from his pot and brings him to Ryan.

RYAN
Goodnight. I love you.

SIMEON
Hmm.

Ryan hesitatingly grabs Simeon's face.

INT. KITCHEN - SUNSET

With the blinds closed, two lanterns light up the kitchen.

Another lantern set to low, sits next to a sleeping Simeon.
Jasmine sleeps on the other side of the couch.

Clean water sits in gallon jugs. Canned food sits in a
duffle.

David looks out one of the upstairs windows, eating and
talking to himself -- a small map in his hands.

DAVID
Two miles south to the gas station.
Nothing. Went northwest probably a
half mile and then west about a
mile--

Leah and Ryan sit on opposite sides of the child's playroom.
Leah closest to Jasmine.

LEAH
Why Reaps?

Ryan raises an eyebrow.

RYAN
It's the noise they make before
their descent.

LEAH
Oh.

DAVID
(to himself)
Following this tree line, we're
probably two miles away from the
van.

RYAN
I thought you guys have seen 'em.

DAVID
But, if we cut through whatever
this cluster of buildings, it's
probably half mile. Stairs.
(to the other two)
Remember stairs.

David looks at the two through his bifocals.

LEAH
On the news back in the beginning.
We thought they were a myth. Maybe
even CGI.

RYAN
And the Laughters? You think they
were CGI, too?

David looks back at Ryan.

DAVID
Be nice.

Rain starts to PATTERN on the roof.

LEAH
Have you guys seen them? The Reaps?

Ryan doesn't acknowledge her. David looks up briefly from his
map towards Leah and gives a small smile.

DAVID
Just one.

Ryan looks down at the rifle in his hands.

DAVID (CONT'D)
Anyways, I'll take the downstairs.
Love you.

RYAN
Love you, too, brother.

DAVID

(to LEAH)

And you. I love you, too. I can't begin to fathom the horrors you and your partner have been through. But when you're with us, you don't have to worry ab-- well, you don't have to worry. We're all in this together.

David carefully puts his hands on her shoulders.

DAVID (CONT'D)

You should get some rest. You're going to need it if you're coming with us tomorrow.

LEAH

We'll do what we want.

DAVID

I wouldn't have it any other way.

(to Ryan)

Gas. Van. Supplies. Sunrise at 6:20.

RYAN

Got it, brother.

DAVID

You want me to take Simeon downstairs or--

RYAN

Up here is fine.

DAVID

Okie doke.

David heads downstairs.

Leah looks at Simeon and Jasmine asleep on the couch.

LEAH

Why'd he think it was interesting that the Reaps were close by?

RYAN

He didn't.

LEAH

That's exactly what he said.

RYAN

He thought it was interesting that
the Reaps are coming from the east
and that the Cal Guard--

Ryan starts taking out the window screen.

RYAN (CONT'D)

--or what's left of it, is coming
from the west.

LEAH

So, you guys are heading to the
National Guard?

RYAN

We are heading in the exact
opposite direction.

LEAH

Why w--

RYAN

You been living under a rock, ain't
cha?

The two stare at each other intensely.

RYAN (CONT'D)

The California State National
Guard, especially for you two, is
worse than a pack of Laughers.

LEAH

What if we-- what if you run into a
Reap tomorrow?

RYAN

If it's in the air, then we're
dead.

LEAH

Why is that?

RYAN

Gut feeling.

Ryan puts a big dip in his mouth.

A long, drawn-out silence as the Ryan keeps an eye out the
window, and Leah keeps an eye on Ryan.

LEAH

Back in the beginning, they said it originated in the Middle East. They said we opened a portal to hell.

Ryan puts the screen behind him.

RYAN

Oh, yeah? How'd we do that?

LEAH

Through the large Halidron Calidor or whatever.

RYAN

The Large Hadron Collider.

Ryan goes and grabs a table chair.

LEAH

Yeah.

RYAN

The Large Hadron Collider is in Switzerland.

Ryan places the chair next to the window.

LEAH

Yeah, but it opened another dimension in Saudi Arabia.

Ryan sits.

RYAN

Anything's possible, I guess.

LEAH

Where do you think they came from?

RYAN

Don't know.

He checks his ammo.

LEAH

Do you think this is hell?

RYAN

In what sense?

LEAH

Actual.

RYAN

Don't know.

LEAH

Do you know anything?

Ryan gives her a hard look.

RYAN

I know that with Reaps, everyone,
no matter the individual, freezes.
That in the moment, you'll feel
your muscles literally lock up.
You'll feel your pupils contract.
You'll feel your stomach drop. And
in those brief seconds, you'll
realize that time ceases to exist
for it will feel like an eternity.
Laughs in packs are vicious, yes.
But, Reaps? By the time you hear
their screams, you're already dead.

Ryan spits in a cup.

RYAN (CONT'D)

Now, get out of my face and leave
me be.

Ryan lays his rifle on top of the window sill. The last
minutes of light appear on the horizon.

LEAH slowly gets up and leaves.

INT. ABANDONED APARTMENT - NIGHT

David sleeps on the bed downstairs, fully clothed. The two
girls sleep in the other room.

UPSTAIRS

Ryan rubs his eyes over the kitchen sink.

He checks on Simeon in the process, as he walks into the play
room.

Ryan sits and looks down at his watch. He grabs his last
cigarette and lights it.

INT. ABANDONED APARTMENT - UPSTAIRS - NIGHT

A long CREAK from the floorboards wakes SIMEON.

SIMEON sits up. He stares at the stairs.

A long, slender, grey arm pokes through the baby gate and grabs a ball.

Sim looks to Ryan, then back at the arm. It retracts. The ball drops and rolls away.

Sim walks over to the ball and picks it up.

He looks down through the baby gate at the

BOTTOM OF THE STAIRS

The front door sits open -- slender fingers grasp the doorframe. Eyes poke out above them and stare at Simeon.

Simeon unlatches the baby gate.

He slowly descends down the dark stairwell.

INT. PLAY ROOM - SAME TIME

Ryan takes a long drag from the cig.

INT. DOWNSTAIRS HALLWAY - NIGHT

Simeon attempts to close the door. He runs around the corner towards the bathroom -- ball in hand.

The front door slowly swings open.

INT. BEDROOM - NIGHT

The FOOTSTEPS of SIMEON stir David awake.

Sim runs inside the bathroom, a smile peaking out through his binky.

David gets up tiredly and walks toward the hallway.

DAVID

Hey, bud. What cha doin' awake?

The ball rolls forward from the bathroom. Simeon follows it.

David goes to pick up Sim. He sees a Laughter out of the corner of his eye stomping towards him.

David grabs Sim and embraces the wall as it passes them and heads into the bathroom.

David creeps back into the bedroom and closes the door.

LEAH (O.S.)
Simeon?

David bites his lip, as he hears the other door open.

INT. DOWNSTAIRS - NIGHT

Leah walks into the hallway, handgun at her side. She flashes a flashlight on and off towards the front door.

Nothing.

LEAH
Ryan?

Footsteps from up above.

INT. BEDROOM - NIGHT

David, wide-eyed, looks at his rifle on the bed.

INT. HALLWAY - NIGHT

Leah flashes the light down the hallway to the bathroom.

Nothing.

She walks towards the stairs and looks up. She sees nothing and turns back. Ryan peeks around at the top -- rifle in hand.

Relaxed, Leah pushes open her bedroom door.

RYAN
Leah?

She hears Ryan's FOOTSTEPS coming down and turns. She notices the bathroom door swing open.

IN THE BEDROOM

Jasmine watches her from the bed. She sees LEAH light the hallway again and freeze.

The flashlight turns off.

JASMINE
What is it?

Multiple FLASHES and GUNSHOTS come from LEAH.

Jasmine sees a Laughers attack and drag her friend out of view.

Ryan sees the Laughers drag her onto the porch. He runs down and closes the door.

Jasmine freezes.

IN A CATATONIC STATE

Jasmine sees Ryan run back and forth through the doorway.

Ryan comes up to her and mouths something. She doesn't hear.

Ryan leaves and grabs the baby carrier back pack. He comes back and grabs her by the shirt.

Ryan drags her to the other bedroom. She sees the Laughers on the porch devouring LEAH's body.

Ryan forces her out the window where David and Simeon are waiting.

EXT. ABANDONED APARTMENT - NIGHT

The group crawls over to a sidewalk -- a battered tricycle sits in the middle.

Ryan sits Jasmine against the wall. He flashes his flashlight in her eyes.

RYAN
(mouthing)
Jasmine? Can you hear me?

JASMINE
My-- my backpack.

RYAN
We'll get your backpack later,
okay? Look at me. I need you to
breathe for me. Okay?

Jasmine takes some deep breaths.

JASMINE
The-- there's fog.

DAVID
Approximately thirty minutes until
sunrise.

RYAN

This place is going to be crawling
with Laughters in three.

DAVID

Let's not be here when that
happens.

RYAN

Agreed.

(to Jasmine)

Look at me, look at me. Can you
move?

Jasmine nods.

DAVID

Let's go.

The group heads down one of the sidewalks.

EXT. APARTMENT COURTYARD - NIGHT

A light blue sky -- not quite red -- appears on the horizon.

The apartment complex sits like a complicated maze. Paths
lead in many directions.

The group stops in the middle of a courtyard. David sits with
his tattered map out.

RYAN

Where to, Dave?

David talks to himself, as he looks at the map.

Ryan scans the buildings and sees various movement inside.

RYAN (CONT'D)

Brother, we need to move.

David doesn't acknowledge.

RYAN (CONT'D)

David.

DAVID

Down the hill and take a left.

RYAN

(to jasmine)

Ready?

Jasmine -- in shock -- nods.

The group runs past some apartments, down some steps. A path is blocked off to their left, so they head right.

A Laugher walks out onto a porch in the distance.

Jasmine lets out a small gasp.

RYAN (CONT'D)

Fuck.

David grabs her by the mouth and pulls her behind a wall.

DAVID

Shh. Shh.

Ryan takes SIMEON off his back and peeks behind the wall. He sees the creature jump onto the railing.

Ryan switches rifles with David and takes aim.

BANG.

The Laugher falls.

Ryan switches rifles again. David helps put SIMEON back on. The group moves forward.

Lampposts flicker on and off in the distance.

EXT. BRIDGE - NIGHT

A long bridge -- surrounded by fog and trees -- is barely illuminated by the night sky.

The group stops at the mouth.

RYAN

This the way?

David lets out a small cough.

DAVID

Over the bridge. Through the parking lot. Up the stairs.

Ryan leads them across. He stops in the middle.

The group separates to the sides.

A lamppost flickers on up ahead. Underneath it stands a tall, dark figure -- its head violently shaking back and forth.

The light goes off.

Movement heads in the opposite direction.

INSANE LAUGHTER.

Ryan lets out a deep breath.

DAVID (CONT'D)
The solar panels must finally be
failing.

RYAN
C'mon.

The group moves forward.

EXT. PARKING LOT - NIGHT

Dozens of vehicles litter the school parking lot. The group maneuvers between them.

Jasmine stops.

She sees something move inside one of the cars. She shakily aims her gun at the window.

Ryan grabs the gun the same time a Laugher places its hand and face on the glass.

Ryan pulls her behind one of the cars and puts his finger to his lips.

JASMINE
Wha--

RYAN
Laughers.

Laughers jump around one of the cars in the distance.

RYAN (CONT'D)
Keep low. Follow us.

Jasmine nods her head and wipes away her tears.

Ryan runs the opposite way of the Laughers.

A DARK STAIRWELL

looms in the distance. The group passes a trail to their left.

They drop to their bellies.

Laughs scurry past.

More INSANE LAUGHTER

The group gets up and stops at the bottom of the steps.

Lampposts light up the dimly lit stairwell -- each one flickering on and off.

Ryan, with assault rifle at the ready, looks up.

JASMINE

I-- is there no other way?

Ryan looks to his brother.

DAVID

Van. Just got to get to the van.

Ryan grasps the barrel of Jasmine's handgun.

RYAN

Finger off the trigger. Only fire
when you absolutely have to, yeah?

Jasmine nods her head.

RYAN (CONT'D)

Deep breaths. Gunfire attracts 'em.

Jasmine nods again.

RYAN (CONT'D)

Silence going up. Stay close.

Ryan looks at both David and Jasmine. He begins the ascent.

The group creeps up slowly -- Ryan and Simeon in front,
Jasmine in the middle, David bringing up the rear.

A quarter of the way up, Ryan scans the trees. He stops the group.

JASMINE

What's up?

David sees Laughs moving in the distance at the bottom.

RYAN

Something's off.

SIMEON

Hmm.

Ryan looks up and sees a Laugher squatting at the top.

RYAN

Nobody move.

JASMINE

(whispers)

Oh, my God.

RYAN

Slowly, slowly back down.

A noise attracts Jasmine's attention to the right. Jasmine loses her footing, but catches herself.

Her gun pointed directly at the strange noise.

JASMINE

(whispers)

Ryan.

Ryan, focused at the top, doesn't respond.

JASMINE (CONT'D)

Ryan.

A Laugher launches at Jasmine off the railing.

She shoots it.

RYAN

Go! Run. Run!

The group descends back down. Laughers lurk right behind.

AT THE BOTTOM

Laughers from the parking lot force the group to cut right onto a trail that leads through a dark forest -- hardly any light peers through.

BOMBS go off in the distance.

EXT. TRAIL - NIGHT

The group rushes through the trail. Laughers follow behind.

INSANE LAUGHTER.

Light at the other end of the dense forest peers through. Not a long distance, but incredibly long when running for your life.

EXT. HILL - SUNRISE

An orange sliver peeks out from the horizon.

Ryan, with Simeon on his back, leads Jasmine and David out of the trail and up the long, grass-covered hill.

The Laughters continue behind, sounding off like a pack of hyenas.

Bombs start bursting in the cloudy sky miles away.

Jasmine slows to watch.

JASMINE
Oh, my God--

DAVID
Cal Guard. Reapers in the sky.
Don't stop, keep moving!

David pushes Jasmine from behind.

She begins to cry.

JASMINE
(out of breath)
I-- I can't make it.

More Laughters join the pack from the sides -- each new addition becoming more and more aggressive.

David starts violently coughing and drops to one knee.

Jasmine stops. David waves her off.

DAVID
Kee-- keep going!

David aims at one of the rapidly moving creatures coming towards him.

BANG.

Ryan turns.

RYAN
David!

David re-cocks the rifle and fires.

Ryan begins running back.

RYAN (CONT'D)
Davi--

DAVID
Go!

Ryan fires his AR-15 at the incoming group of ghouls.

David fires multiple rounds. Ryan witnesses David get consumed by the pack of Laughers.

DAVID (CONT'D)
Go! Save your son!

The Laughers tear off the limbs and head of the struggling David and scurry off in random directions.

RYAN
Come on.

Ryan grabs the frozen Jasmine by the strap of her backpack.

EXT. HILLTOP PARKING LOT - SUNRISE

A lone van sits atop the overlooking parking lot.

Ryan, holding Sim, and Jasmine climb up the steep hill and see it.

Both out of breath, they look over the valley of trees and fog.

Laughers laugh and run through the dense brush of the forest.

Jasmine grabs Ryan's hand and holds onto it.

CUT TO BLACK: